

Emotions & Topics in the Swiss Parliament (1999–2025)

Students project UZH × DemoSquare

May 1, 2026

What this deck covers

Part I — Nationalrat

- ▶ Floor-time shares
- ▶ Topics and agenda shifts
- ▶ Emotional rhetoric and dominant emotions
- ▶ Gender, cantons, age/cohort, language, applause

Part III — Focus

- ▶ Cross-country comparison (five legislatures, same method)
- ▶ National Council vs Council of States (emotional share and anger)
- ▶ Case studies: Federal Council entry and Albert Rösti

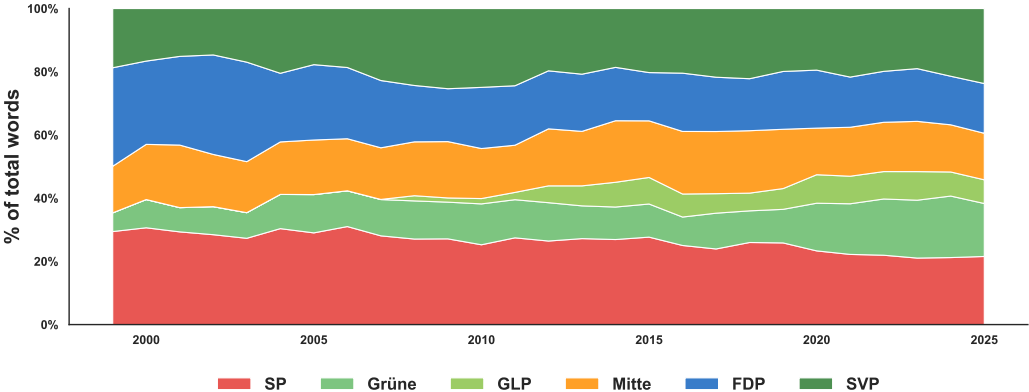
Appendix: supplementary emotion-by-topic panels and robustness figures.

Part II — Ständerat

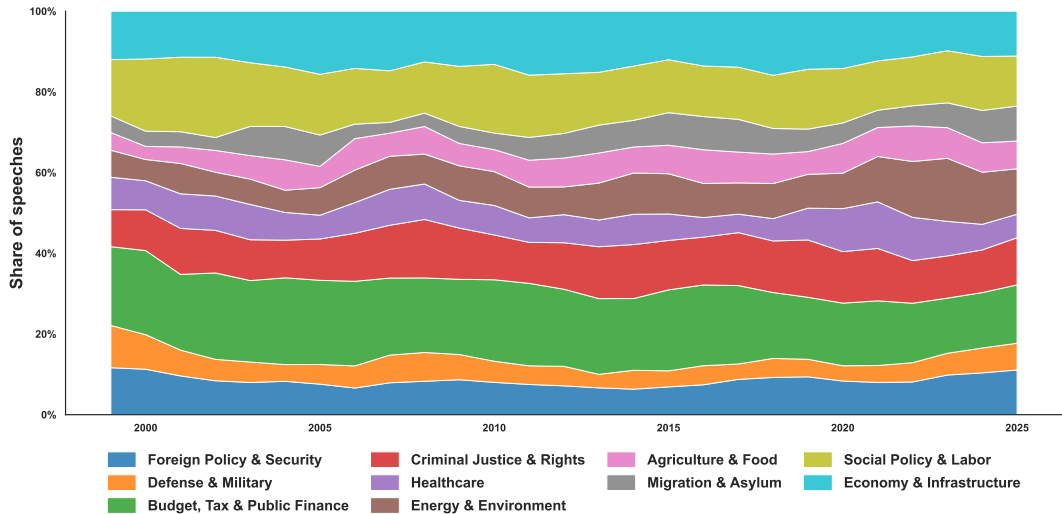
- ▶ Floor-time shares
- ▶ Topics and agenda shifts
- ▶ Emotional rhetoric and dominant emotions
- ▶ Gender, cantons, age/cohort, language, applause

Part I: Nationalrat

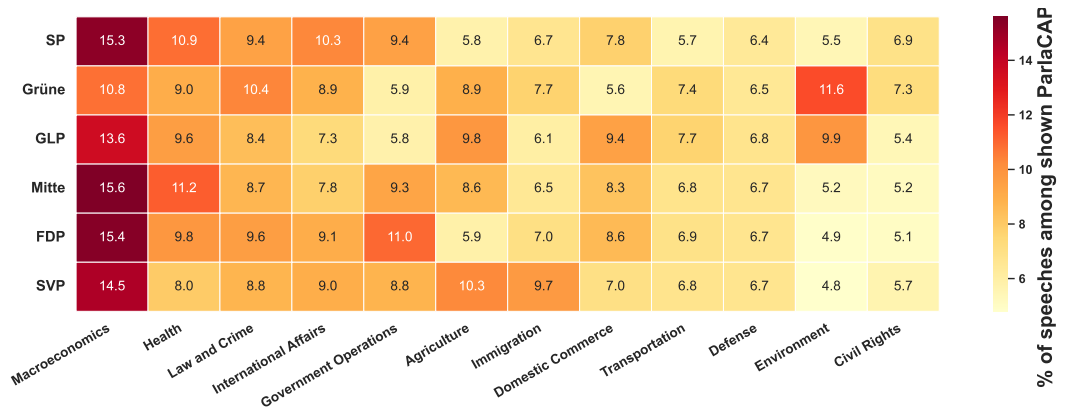
Floor Time Share by Party — Nationalrat



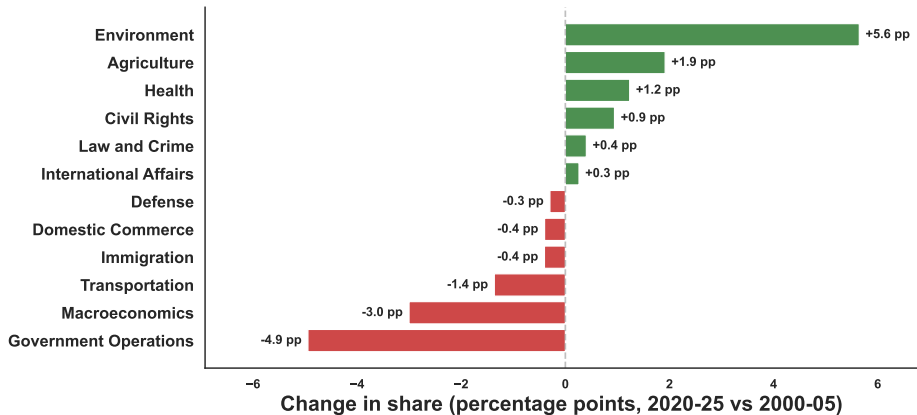
Topic Distribution Over Time — Nationalrat



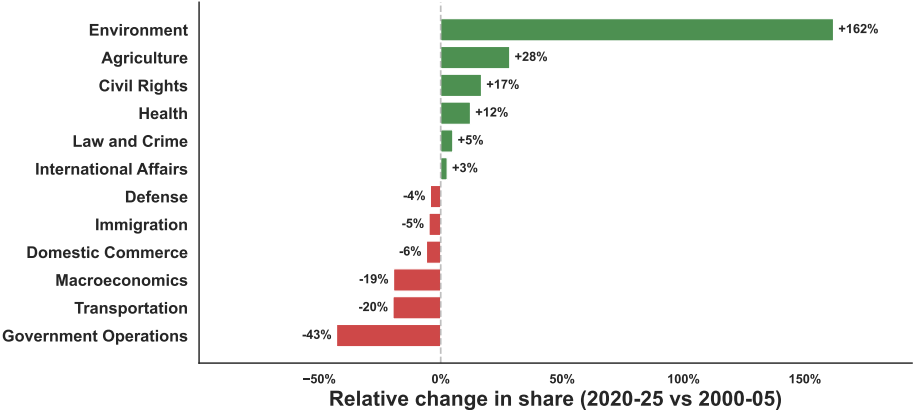
Topic Emphasis by Party — Nationalrat



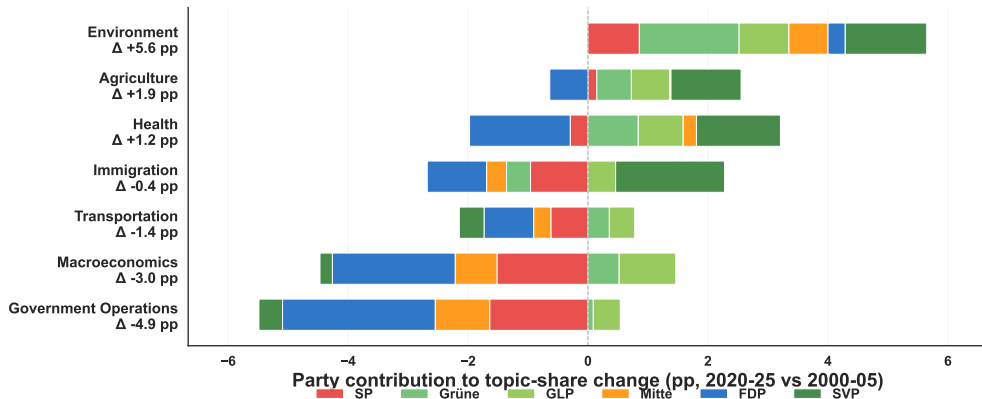
Absolute Shift in Parliamentary Attention — Nationalrat



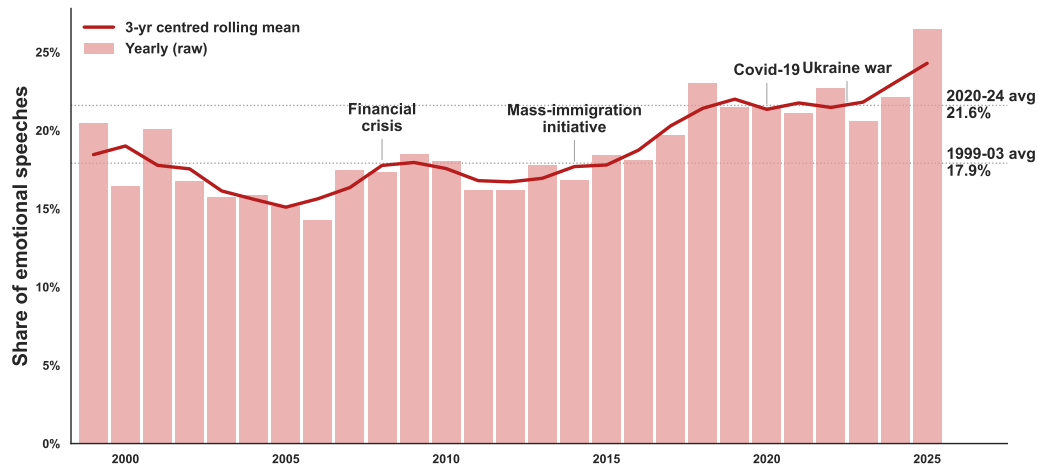
Relative Shift in Parliamentary Attention — Nationalrat



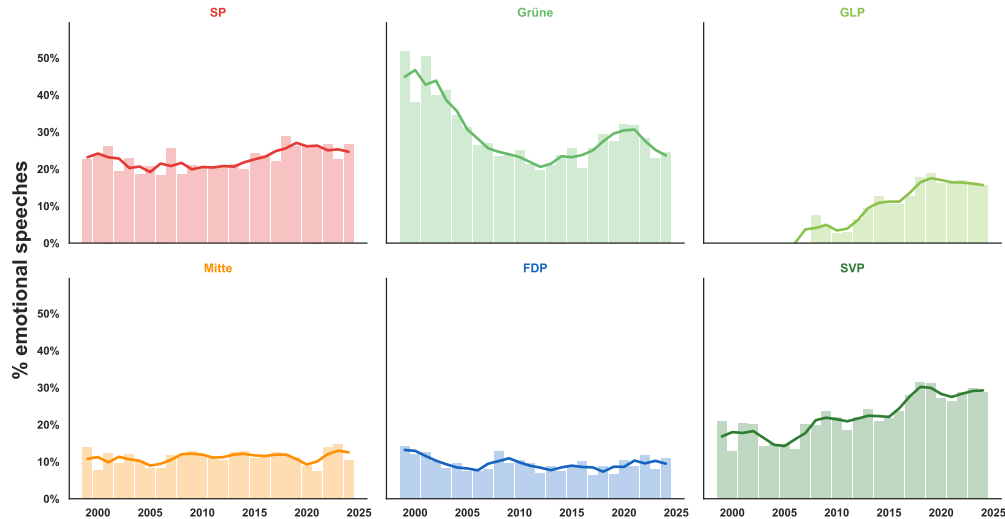
Who Drives Topic Shifts? — Nationalrat



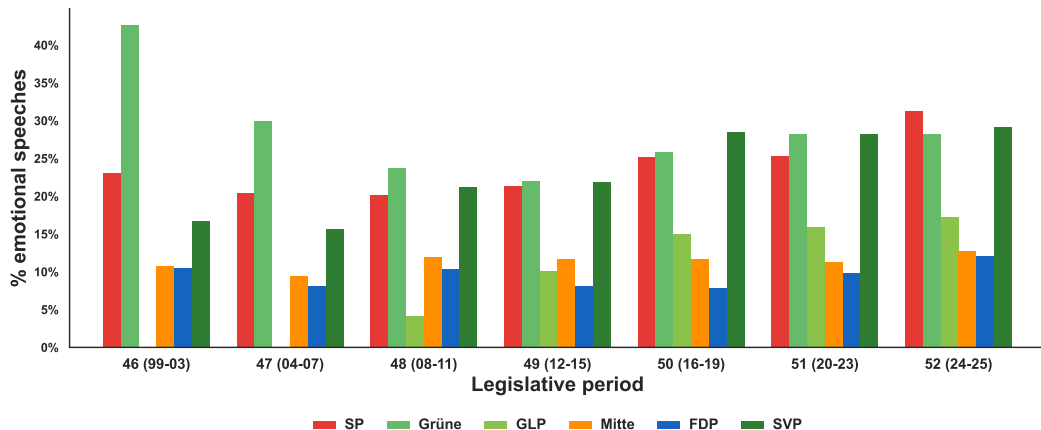
Emotional Rhetoric — Nationalrat



Emotional Rhetoric by Party — Nationalrat

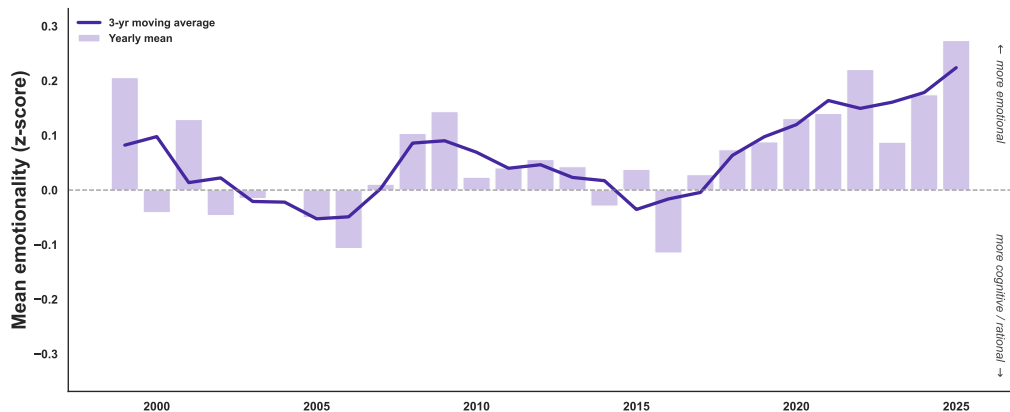


Emotional Rhetoric by Legislature and Party — Nationalrat



Note: Periods are split at federal National Council election dates (October; first sittings of the new parliament are from that election onward). GLP (PVL) entered with the 2007 election (48th period), so there is no 47th-period bar for GLP.

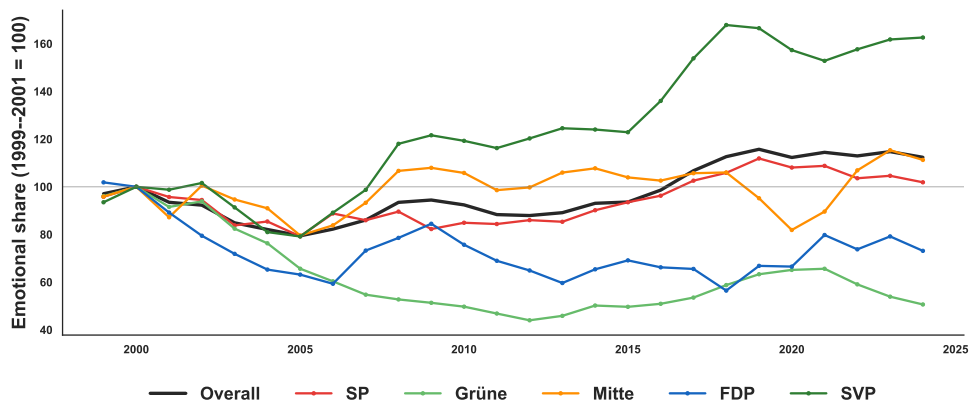
Emotional Rhetoric Score — Nationalrat



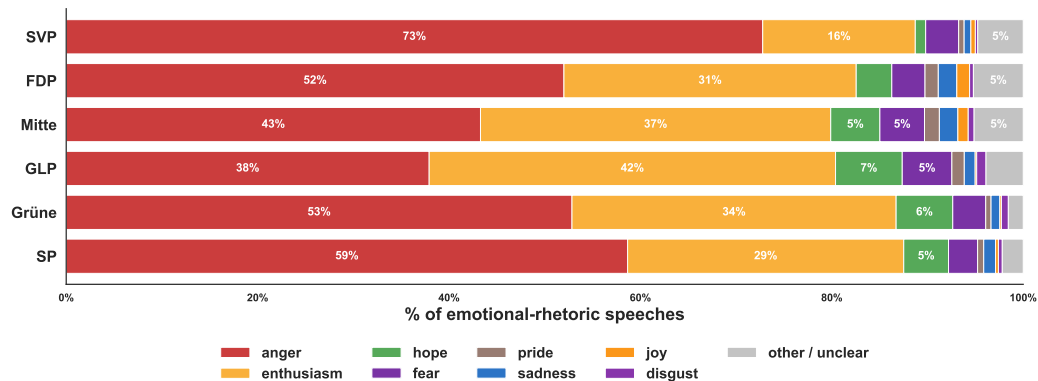
Emotional Rhetoric Score by Party — Nationalrat



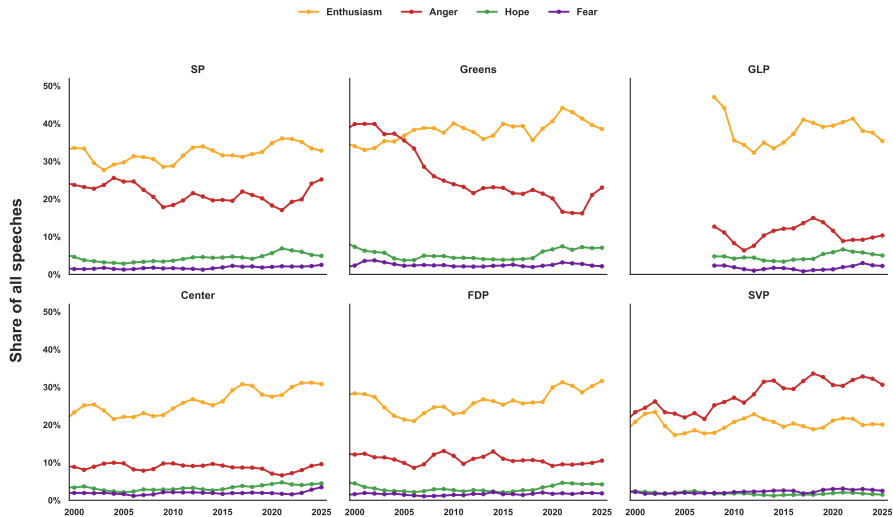
Emotional Rhetoric Baseline Index — Nationalrat



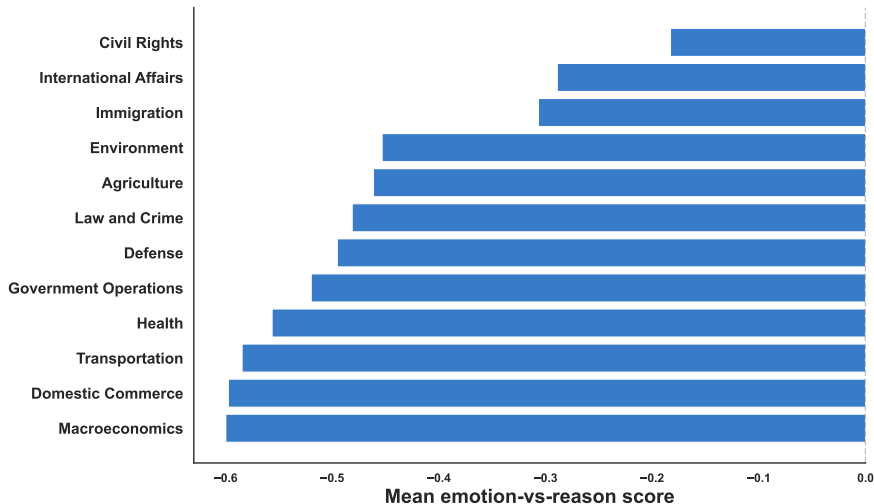
Dominant Emotion in Emotional Speeches — Nationalrat



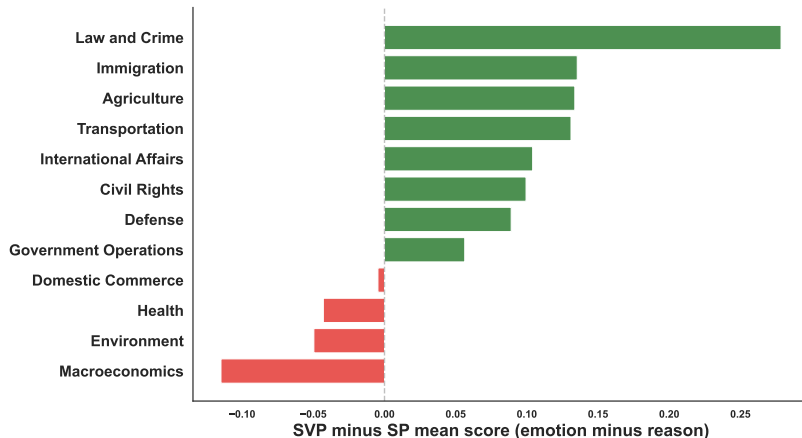
Enthusiasm, Anger, Hope, Fear by Party — Nationalrat



Emotional Rhetoric by Topic — Nationalrat

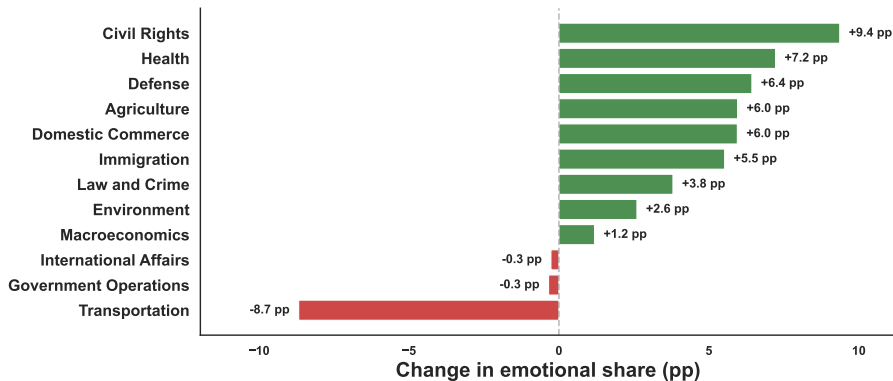


Emotional Rhetoric Gap by Topic (SVP vs SP) — Nationalrat

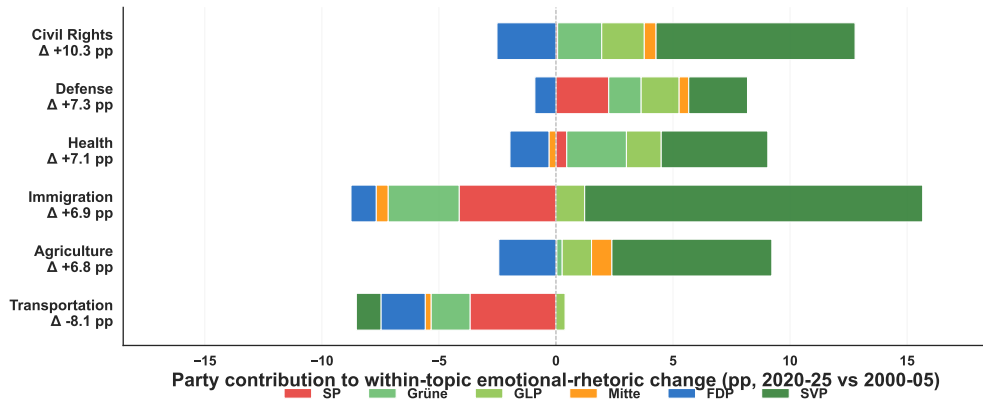


Per topic: mean Gennaro-Ash style score for SVP speeches minus that for SP (+1 emotion-like, 0 neutral, -1 reason-like).

Emotional Rhetoric by Topic — Shift — Nationalrat

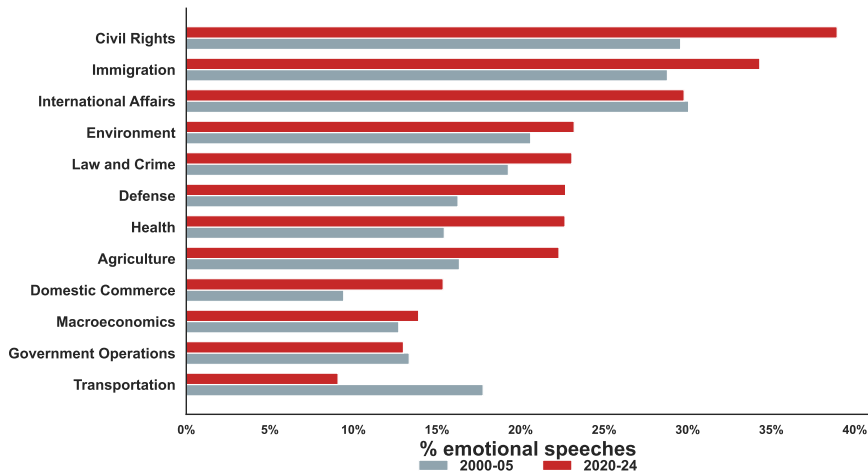


Who Drives Emotional-Rhetoric Shifts Within Topics? — Nationalrat



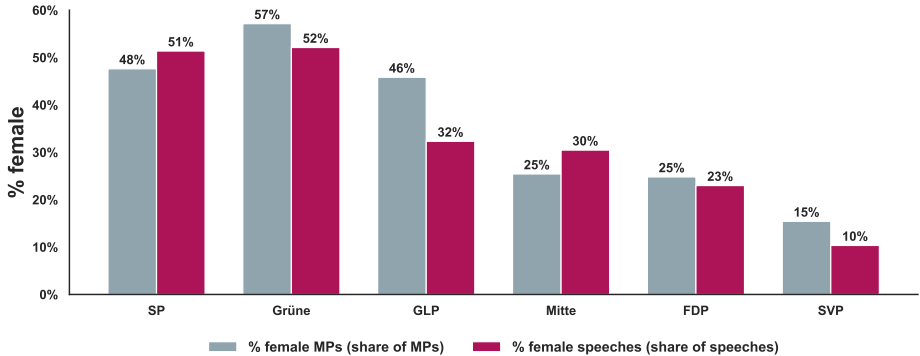
Appendix: tabular party contributions (same decomposition in table form).

Emotional Rhetoric by Topic — 2000–05 vs 2020–24 — Nationalrat

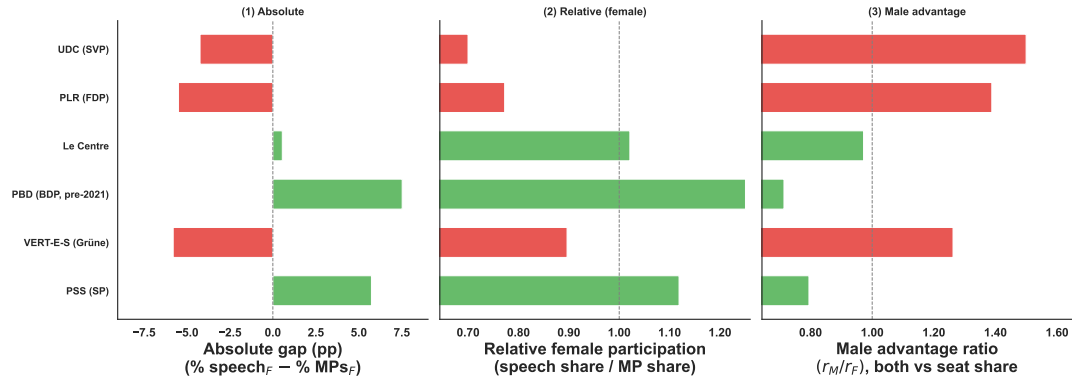


Note: Topic bars pool all six parties; GLP (PVL) had only minimal National Council floor time in 2000–05, so the early window is driven mainly by the longer-established parties.

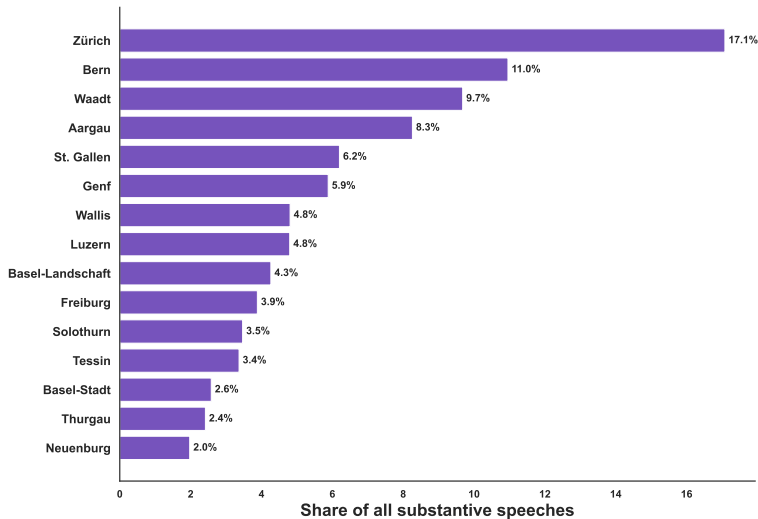
Gender Representation by Party — Nationalrat



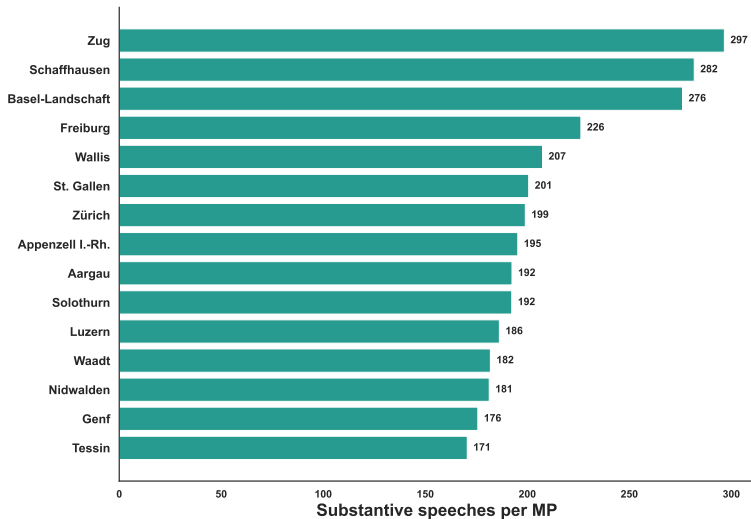
Floor-Time Gap by Gender — Nationalrat (1999–2025)



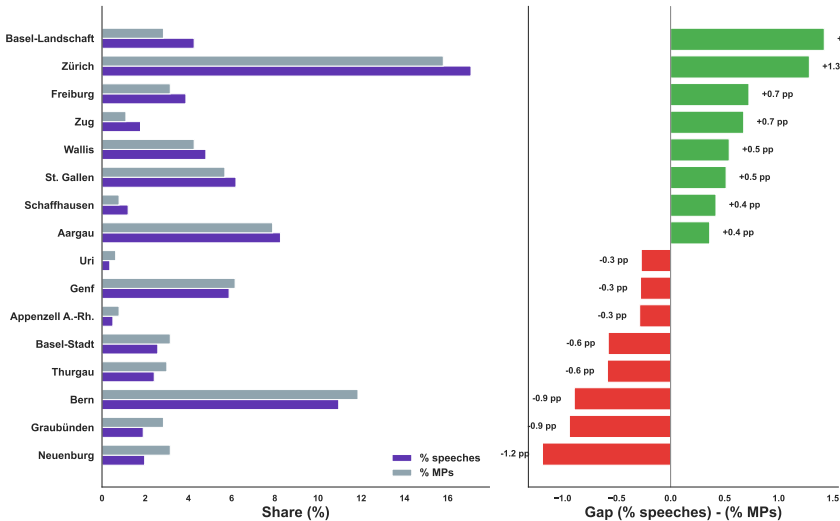
Canton Share of Speeches — Nationalrat



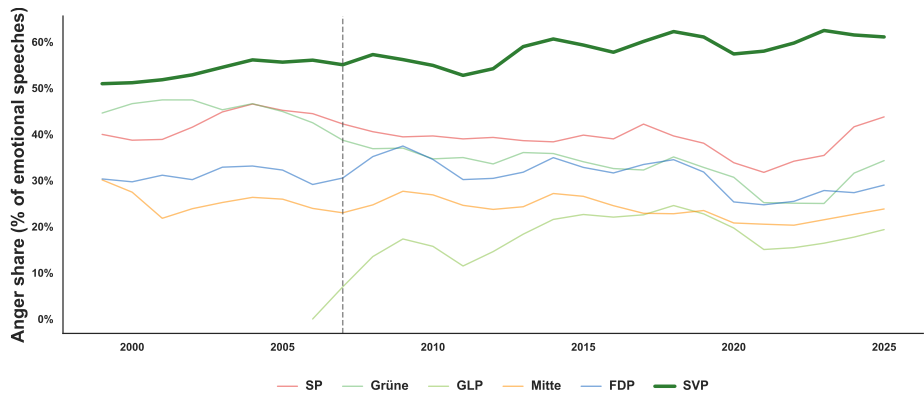
Canton Speeches per MP — Nationalrat



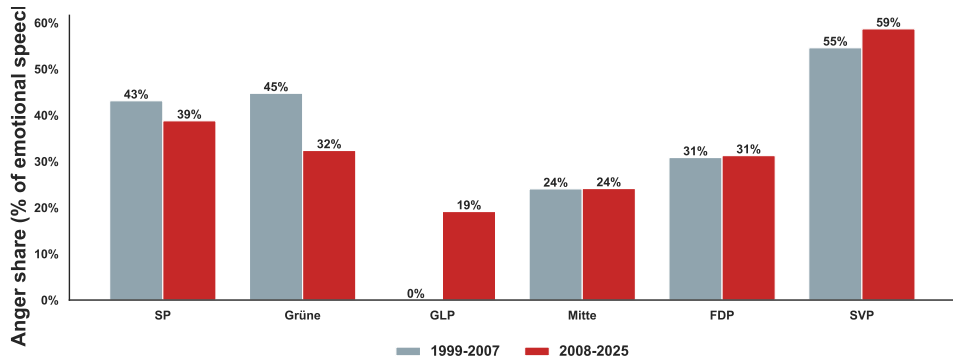
Floor-Time Gap by Canton — Nationalrat



SVP Anger Before and After 2007 — Nationalrat

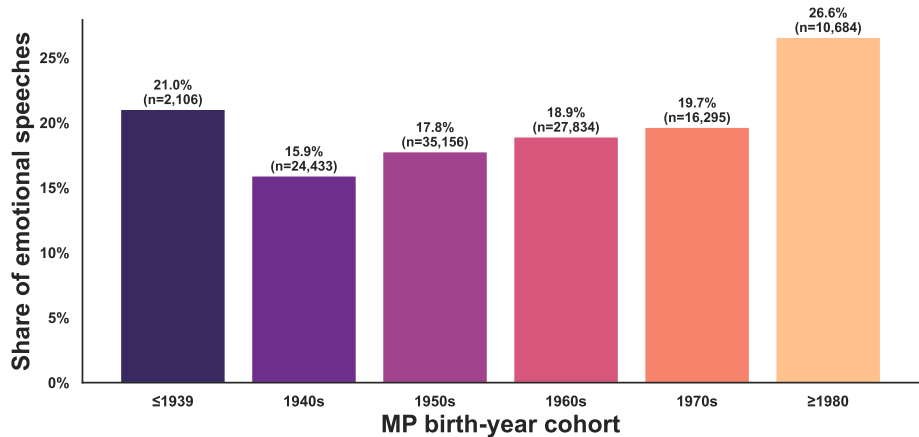


Anger Pre-2007 vs Post-2007 by Party — Nationalrat



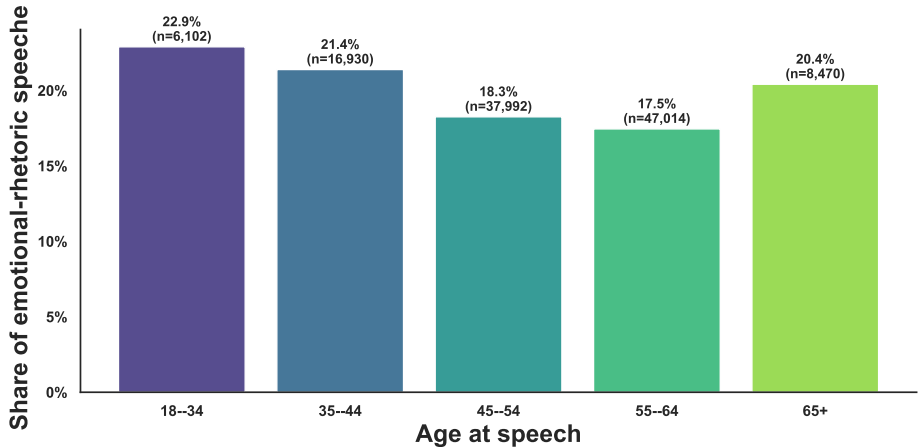
Note: GLP (PVL) enters the National Council only after the October 2007 election; its pre-2008 bar is based on a tiny winter-session slice and should be treated as illustrative only.

Emotional Rhetoric by Generation of MPs — Nationalrat

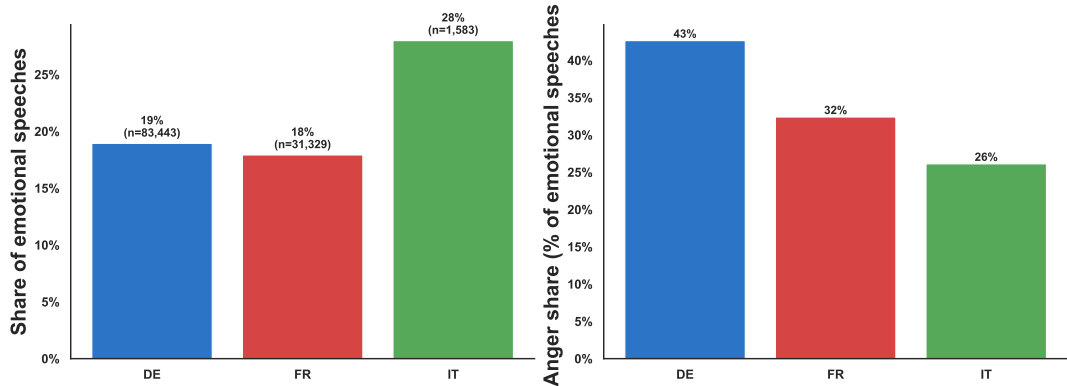


Note: Younger birth cohorts appear here mostly at ages under 50; older cohorts mostly over 50 in this corpus window. Level differences can mix a **cohort** story with an **age-at-speech** story; the next slide (age groups) is complementary but does not fully separate the two.

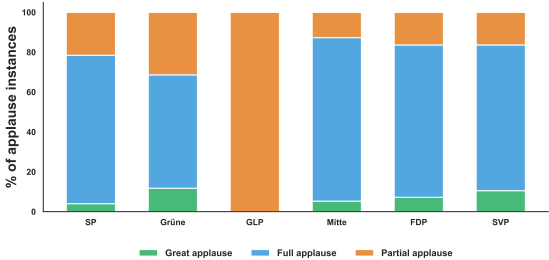
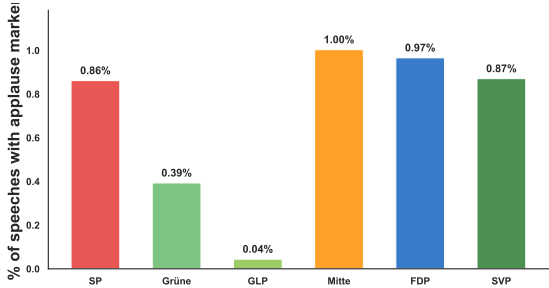
Emotional Rhetoric by Age Group — Nationalrat



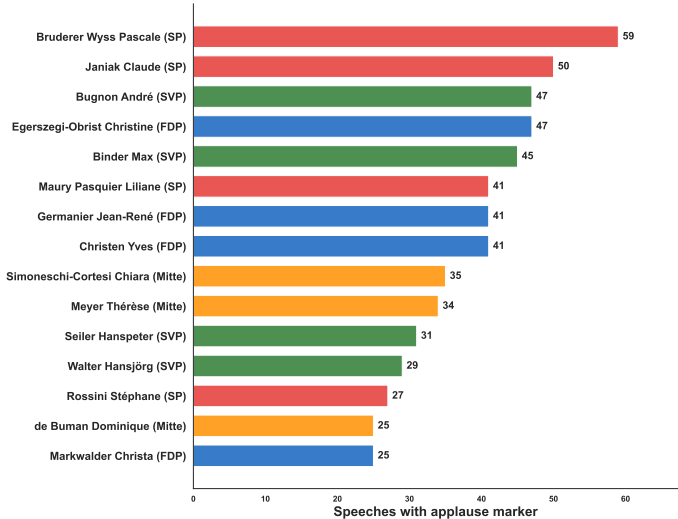
Emotional Rhetoric by Language of the Speech — Nationalrat



Applause by Party — Nationalrat

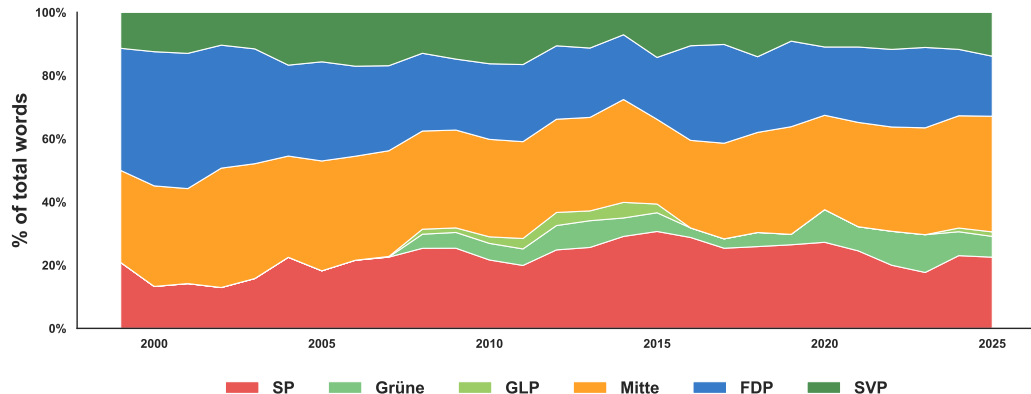


Most Applauded Parliamentarians — Nationalrat



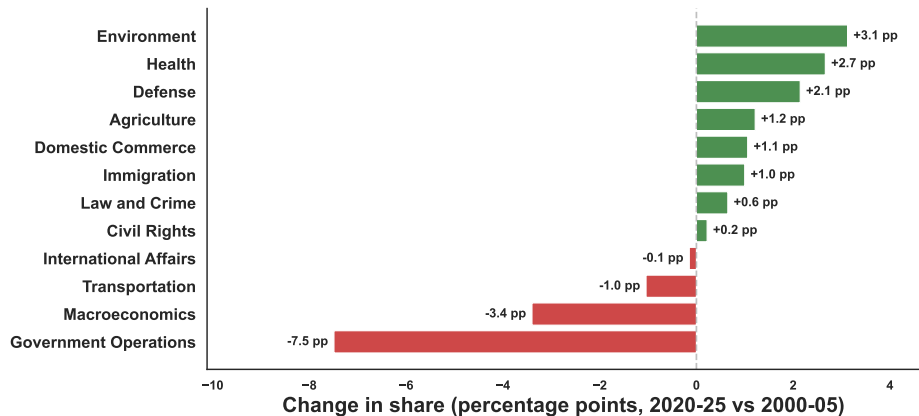
Part II: Ständerat

Floor Time Share by Party — Ständerat



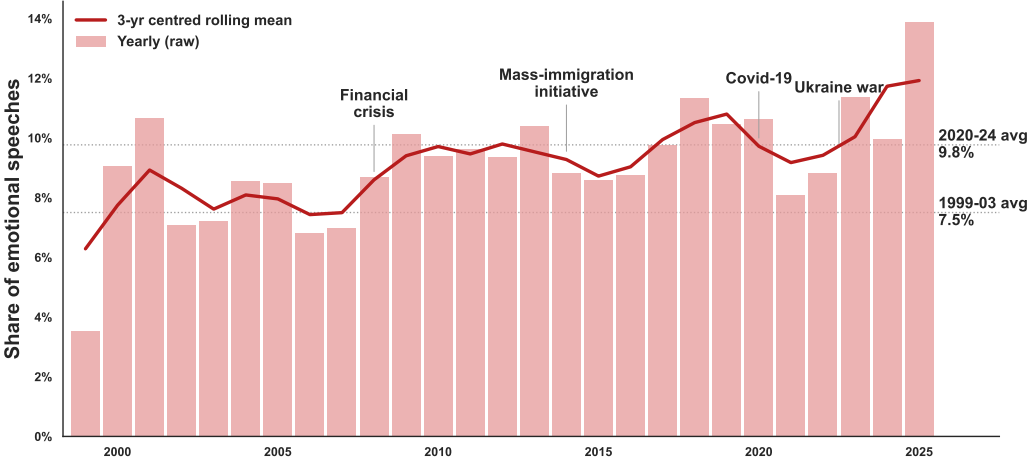
Detailed Ständerat topic checks are in the [appendix](#).

Topic Shift — Ständerat



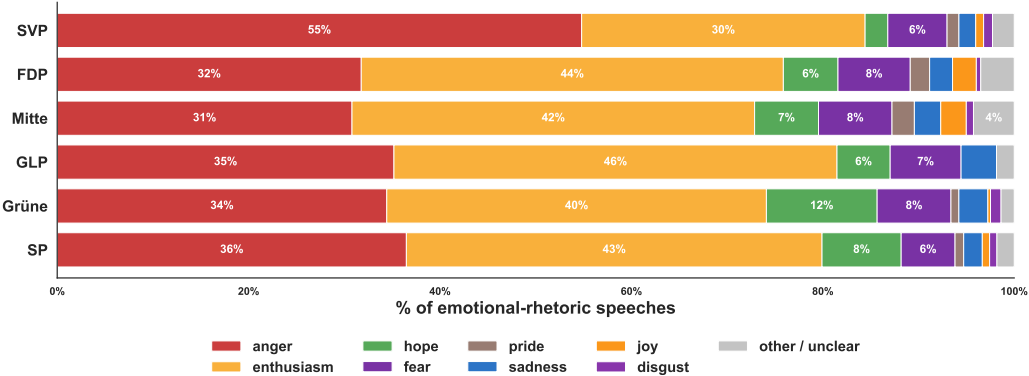
Appendix: topic distribution, relative shift, party drivers.

Emotional Rhetoric — Ständerat



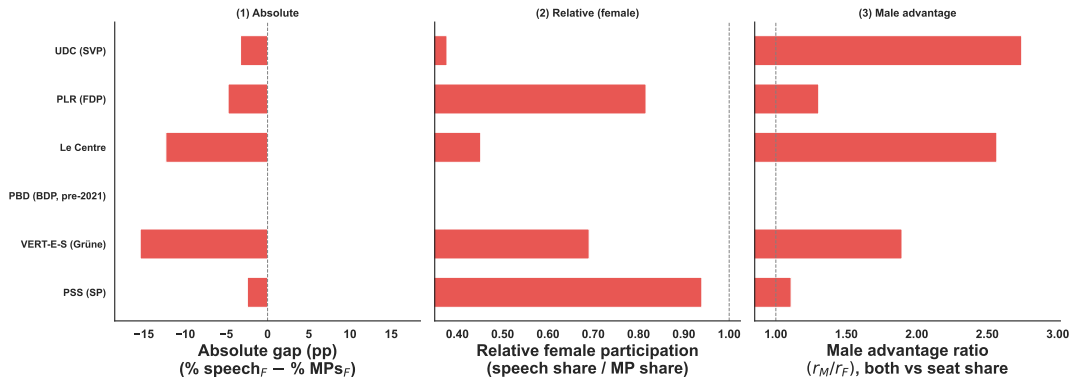
Appendix: party, legislature and topic emotion checks.

Dominant Emotion in Emotional Speeches — Ständerat



Appendix: Ständerat emotion robustness figures.

Floor-Time Gap by Gender — Ständerat (1999–2025)



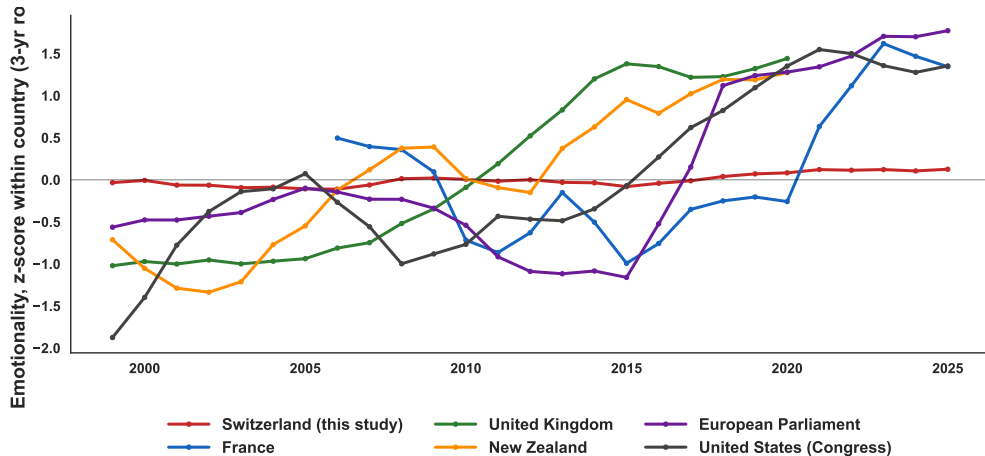
Appendix: Ständerat gender, canton, age, language and applause checks.

Appendix Preview — Detailed Ständerat Checks

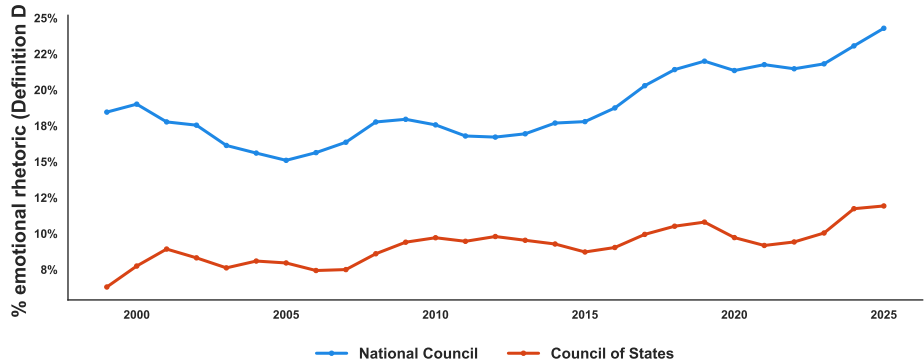
- ▶ Topic distribution, relative shift and party drivers
- ▶ Party, legislature and topic-level emotion checks
- ▶ Gender, canton, age, language and applause checks

Part III: Focus

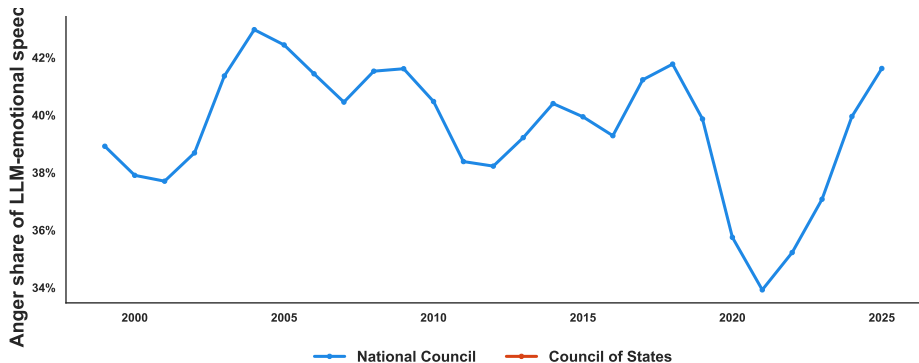
Six Legislatures, One Method — Existing Comparison



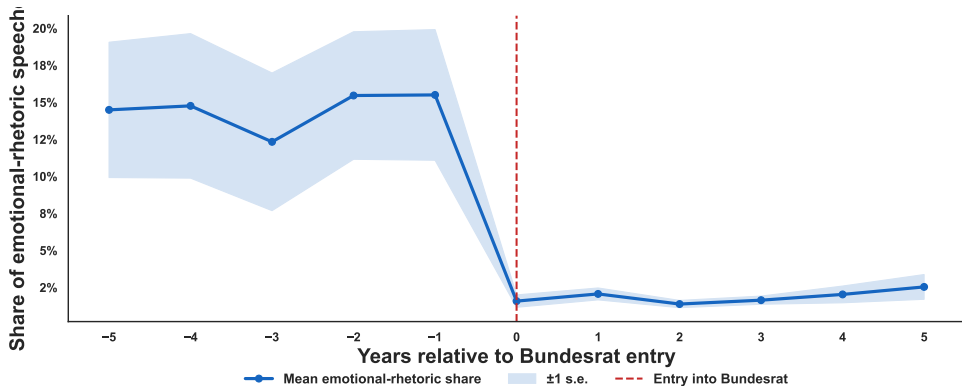
National Council vs Council of States — Emotional Share



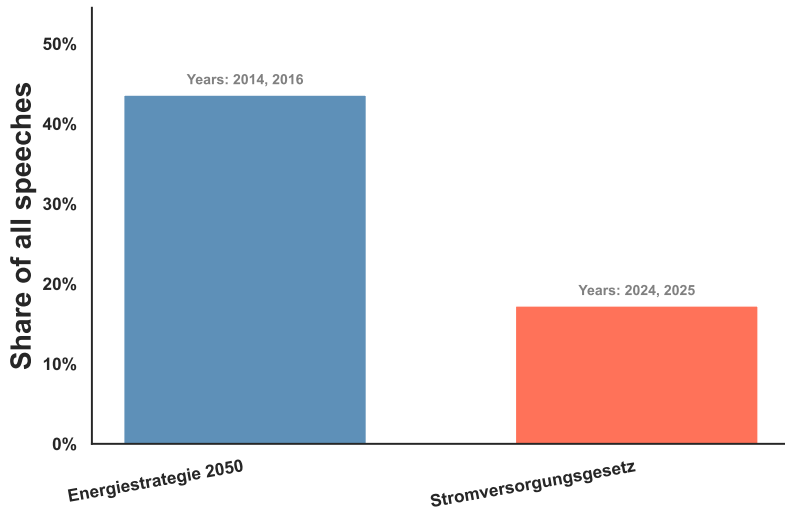
Anger Dominance by Chamber



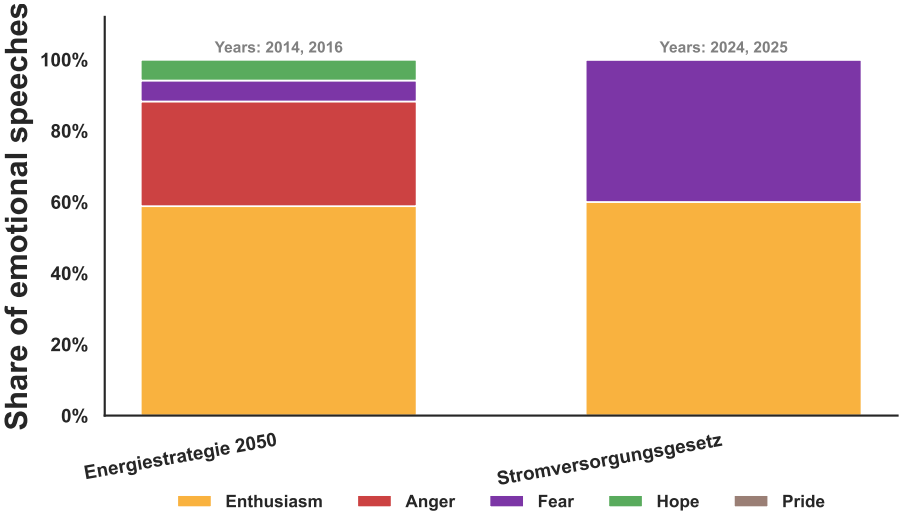
Albert Rösti — Emotional Rhetoric Before and After Joining the Bundesrat



Albert Rösti — Share of Emotional Speeches



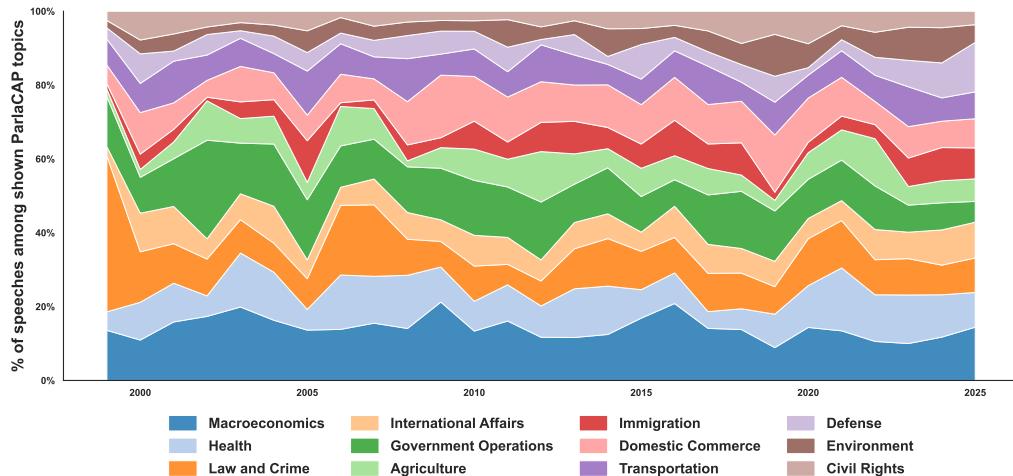
Albert Rösti — Dominant Emotion Share by Business



Appendix

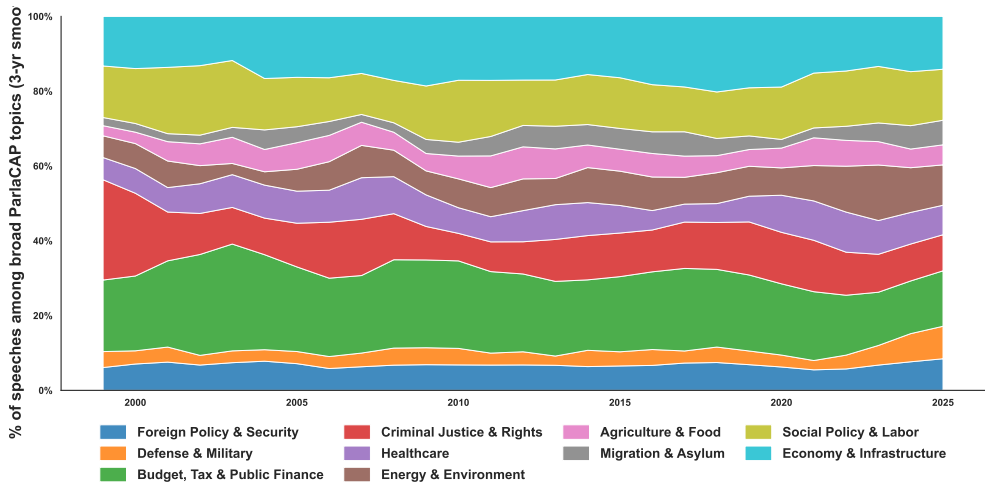
Detailed emotion-by-topic panels and extras

Appendix — Topic Distribution Over Time — Ständerat



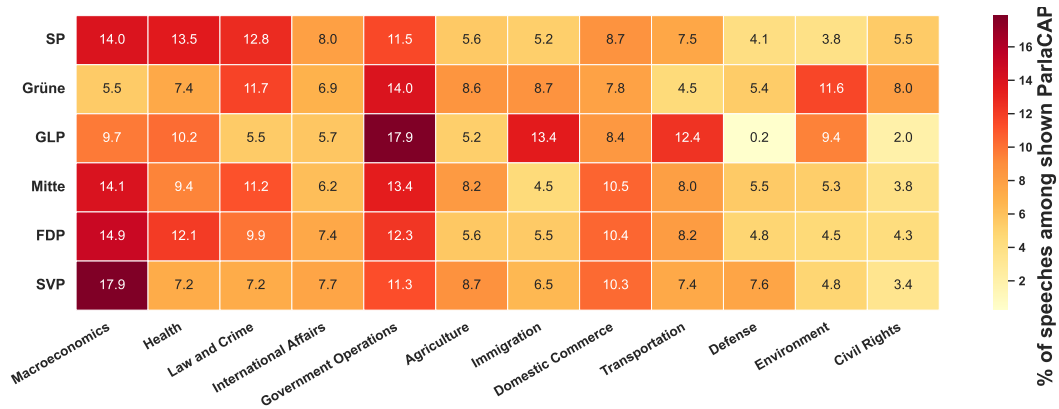
[Back to condensed Ständerat topic slide.](#)

Appendix — Aggregated Topic Distribution Over Time — Ständerat



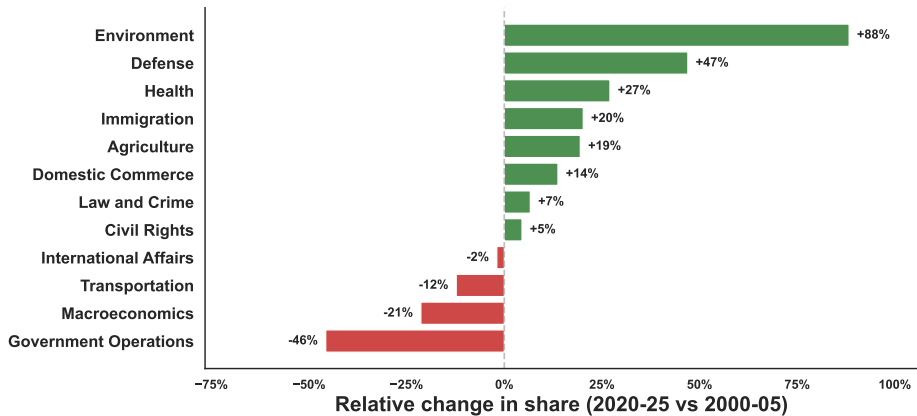
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Appendix — Topic Emphasis by Party — Ständerat



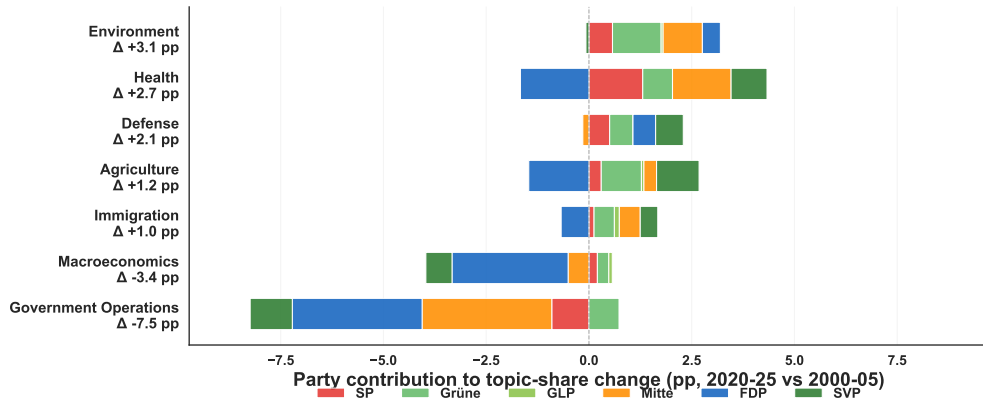
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Appendix — Relative Shift in Parliamentary Attention — Ständerat



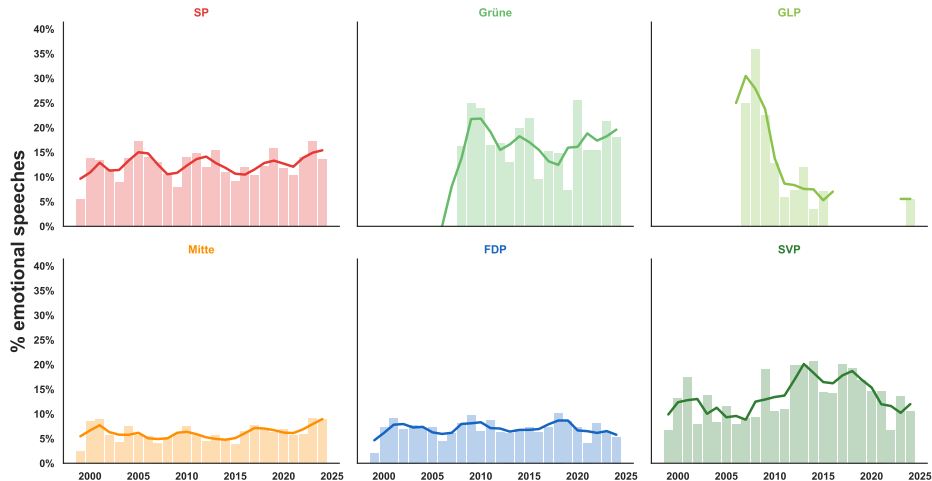
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Appendix — Who Drives Topic Shifts? — Ständerat



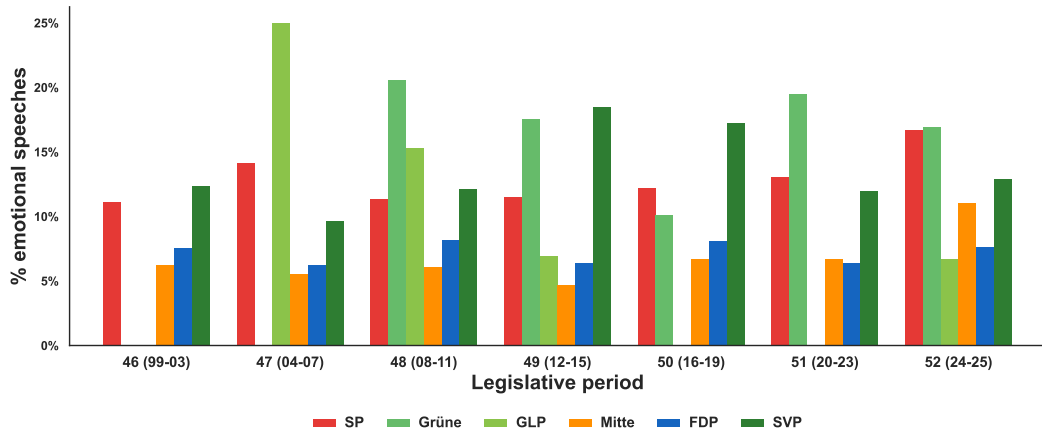
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Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Party — Ständerat



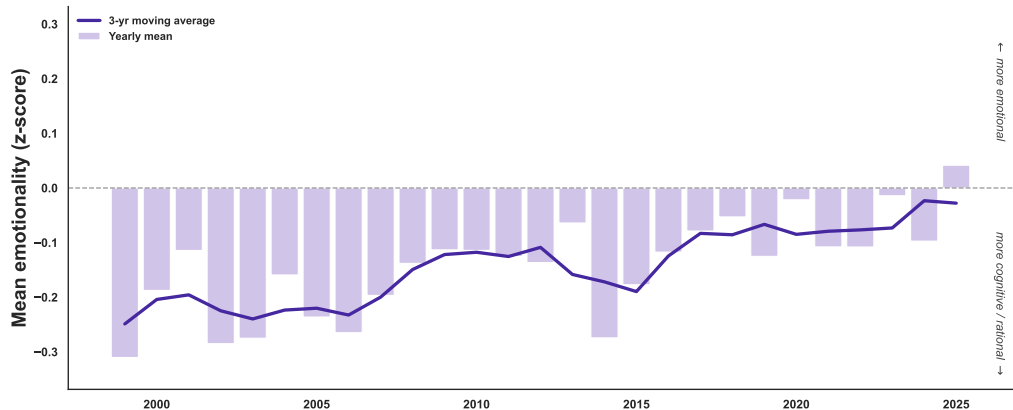
[Back to condensed Ständerat emotion slide.](#)

Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Legislature and Party — Ständerat



Note: Same legislature boundaries as for the National Council (October federal elections). GLP (PVL) entered with the 2007 election; there is no 47th-period bar for GLP. [Back to condensed Ständerat emotion slide.](#)

Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric Score — Ständerat



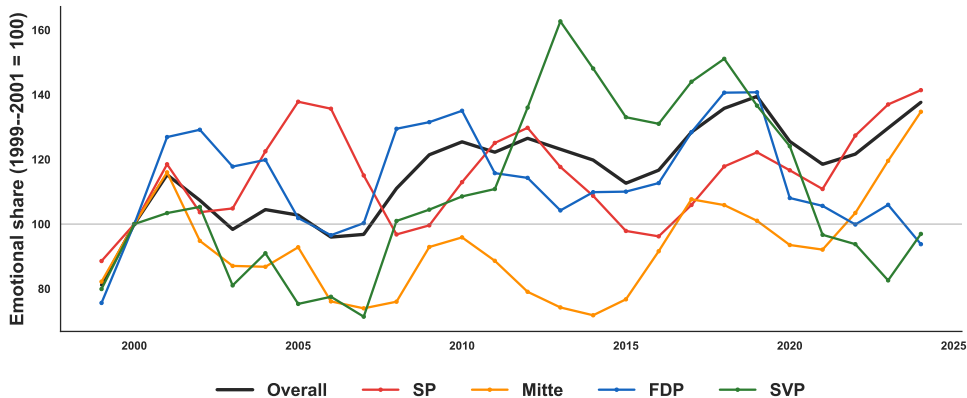
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Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric Score by Party — Ständerat



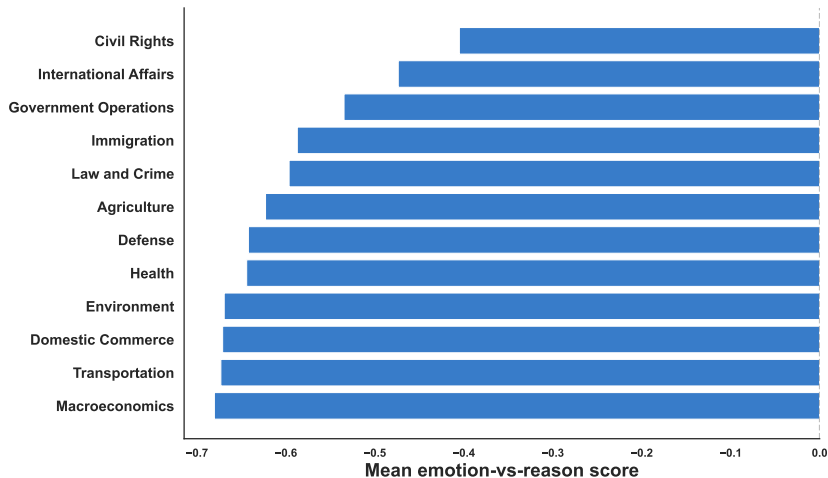
[Back to condensed Ständerat slide.](#)

Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric Baseline Index — Ständerat



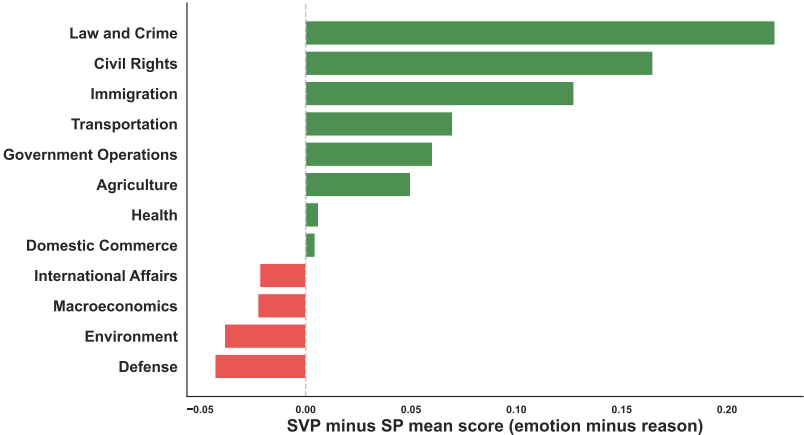
[Back to condensed Ständerat slide.](#)

Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Topic — Ständerat



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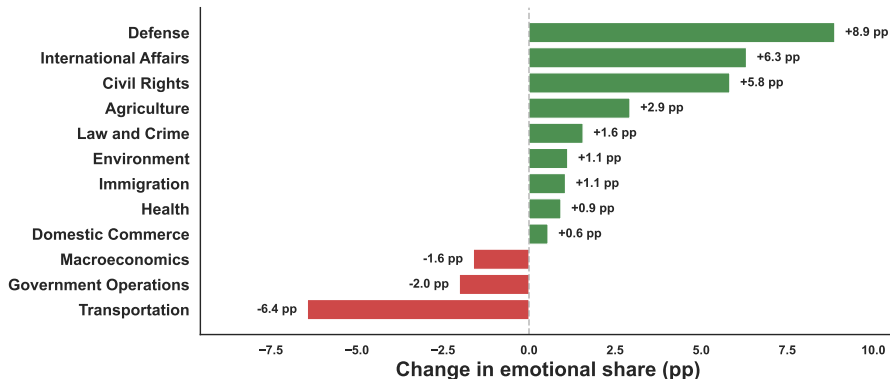
Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric Gap by Topic (SVP vs SP) — Ständerat



Per topic: mean Gennaro–Ash style score for SVP speeches minus that for SP (+1 emotion-like, 0 neutral, -1 reason-like).

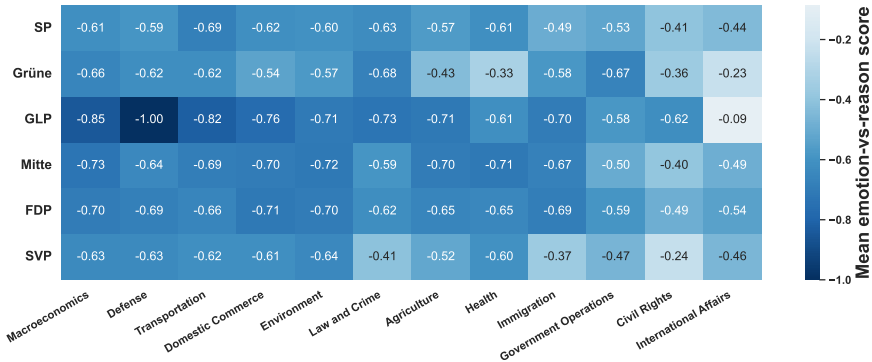
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Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Topic — Shift — Ständerat



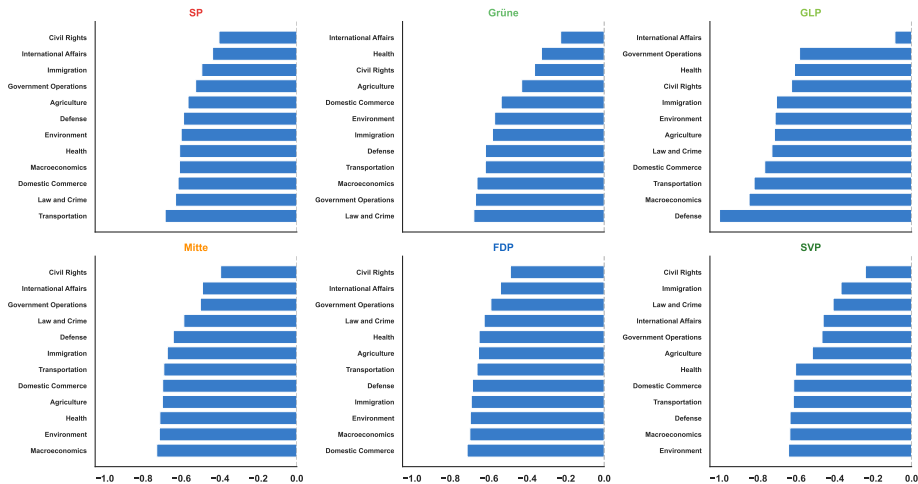
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Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Topic and Party — Ständerat



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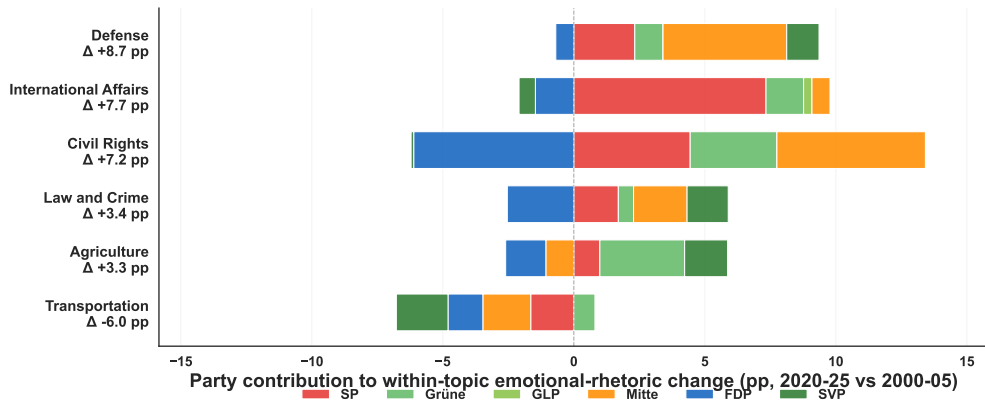
Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Topic, One Panel per Party — Ständerat



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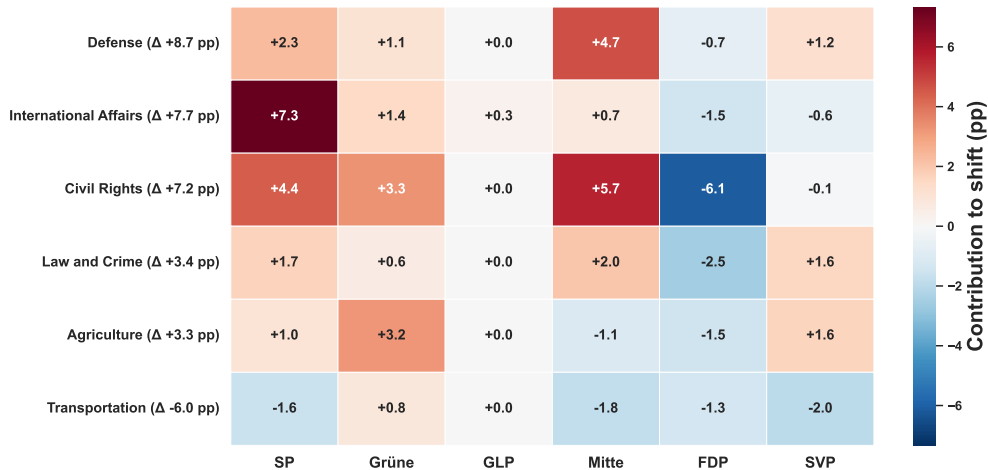
Appendix — Who Drives Emotional-Rhetoric Shifts Within Topics?

— Ständerat



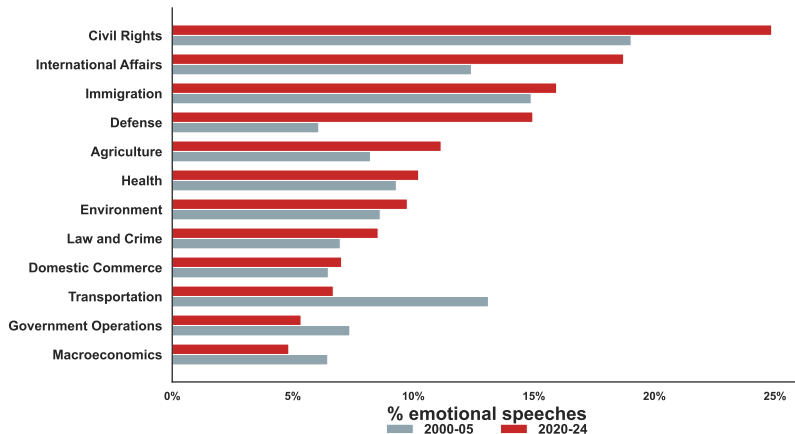
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Appendix — Emotional-Rhetoric Shift Contributions by Party — Ständerat



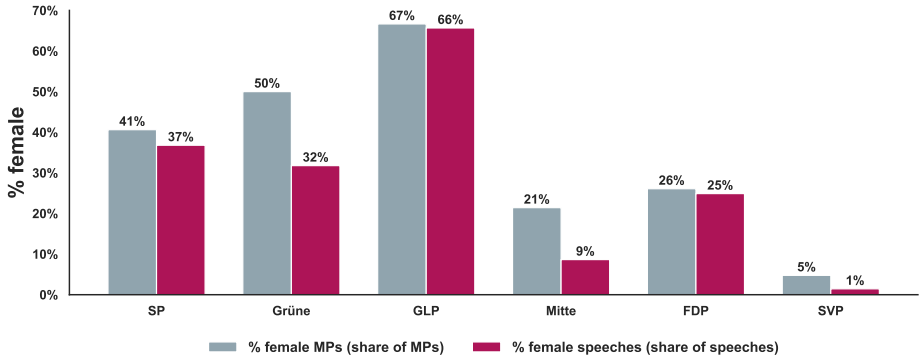
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Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Topic — 2000–05 vs 2020–24 — Ständerat



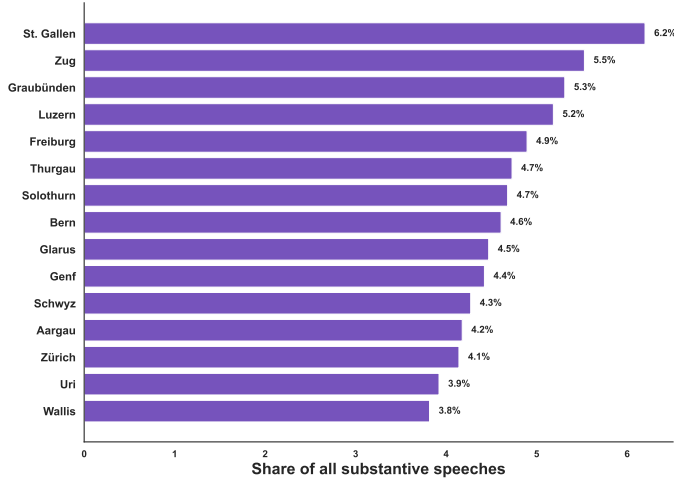
Note: Bars pool all six parties; GLP had minimal Council of States floor time in 2000–05. [Back](#).

Appendix — Gender Representation by Party — Ständerat



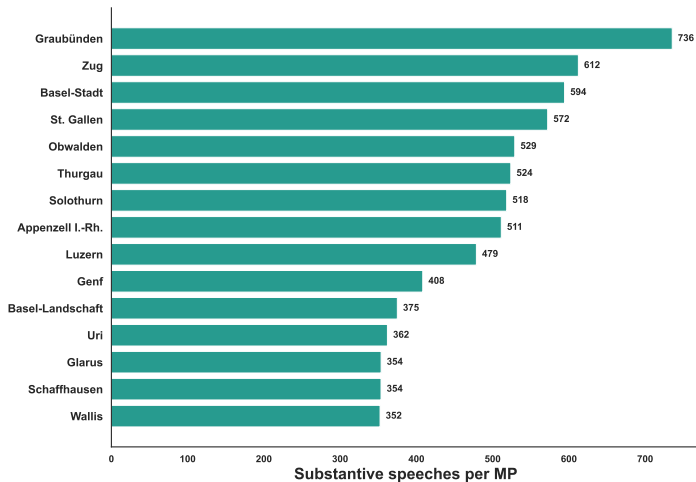
[Back to condensed Ständerat gender slide.](#)

Appendix — Canton Share of Speeches — Ständerat



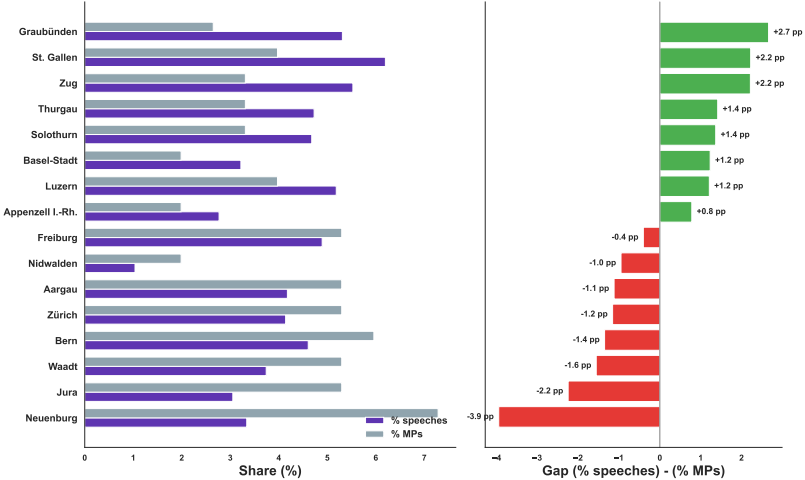
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Appendix — Canton Speeches per MP — Ständerat



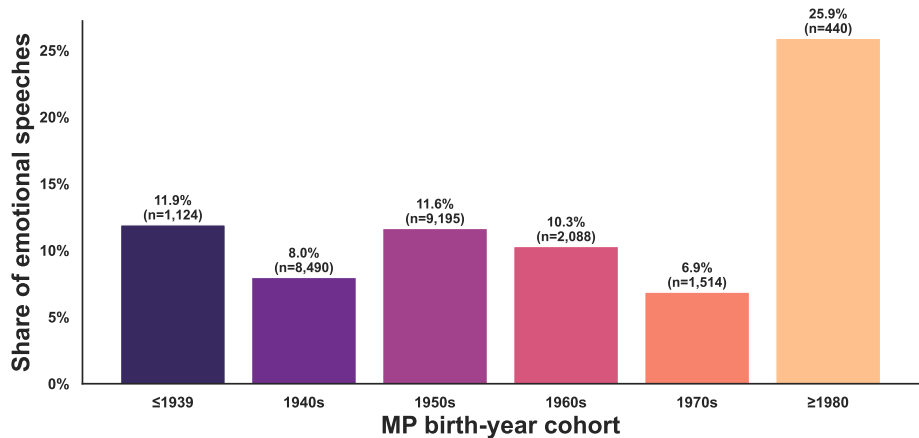
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Appendix — Floor-Time Gap by Canton — Ständerat



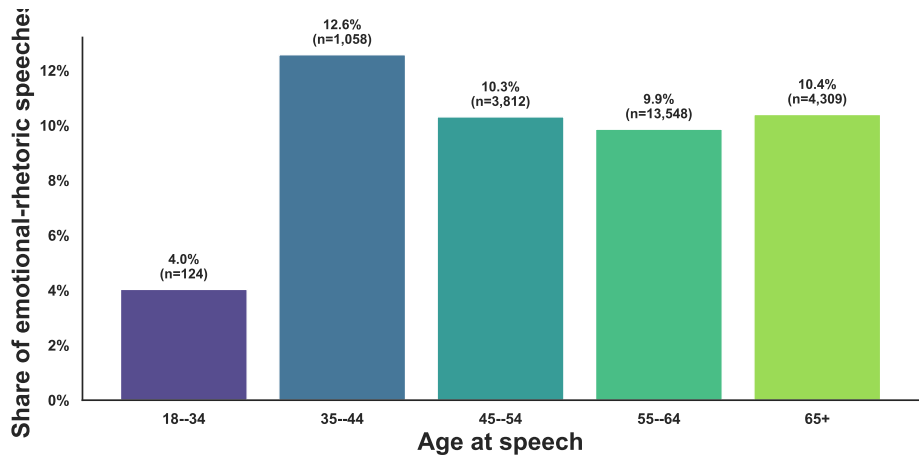
Back to condensed Ständerat slide.

Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Generation of MPs — Ständerat



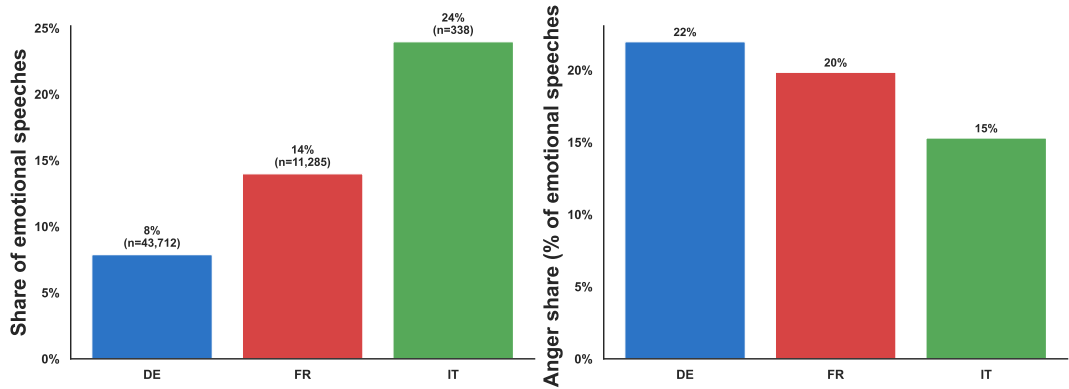
Note: Younger birth cohorts appear here mostly at ages under 50; older cohorts mostly over 50 in this corpus window. Level differences can mix a **cohort** story with an **age-at-speech** story. [Back to condensed Ständerat gender slide.](#)

Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Age Group — Ständerat



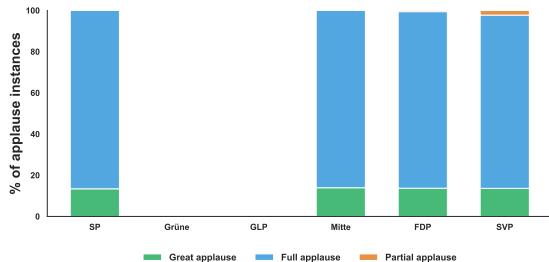
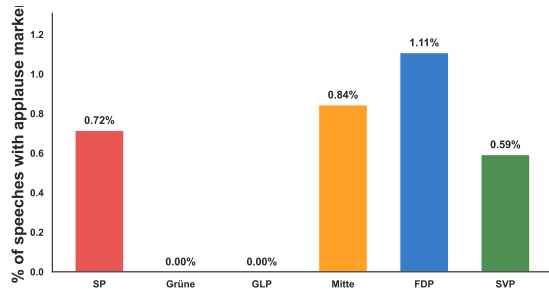
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Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Language of the Speech — Ständerat



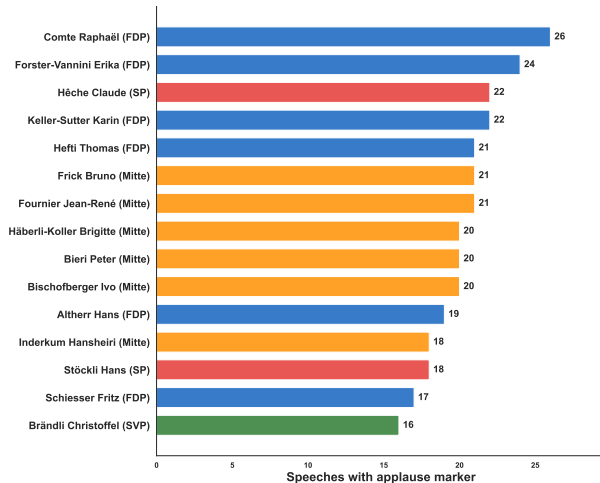
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Appendix — Applause by Party — Ständerat



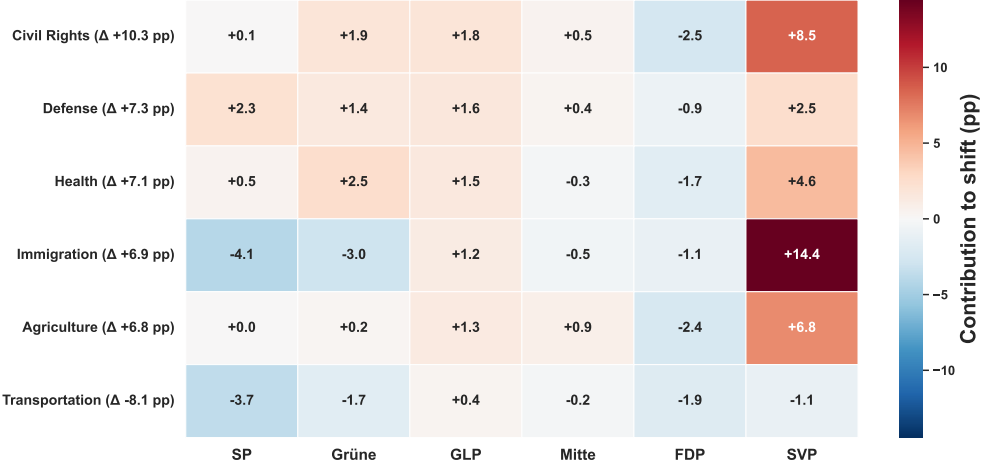
[Back to condensed Ständerat gender slide.](#)

Appendix — Most Applauded Parliamentarians — Ständerat



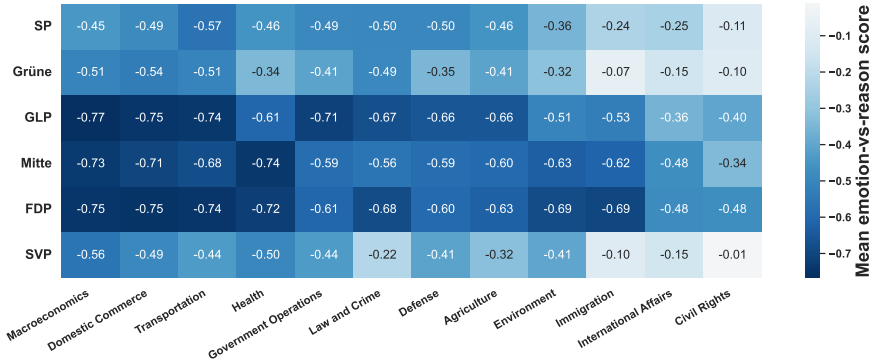
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Appendix — Emotional-Rhetoric Shift Contributions by Party — Nationalrat

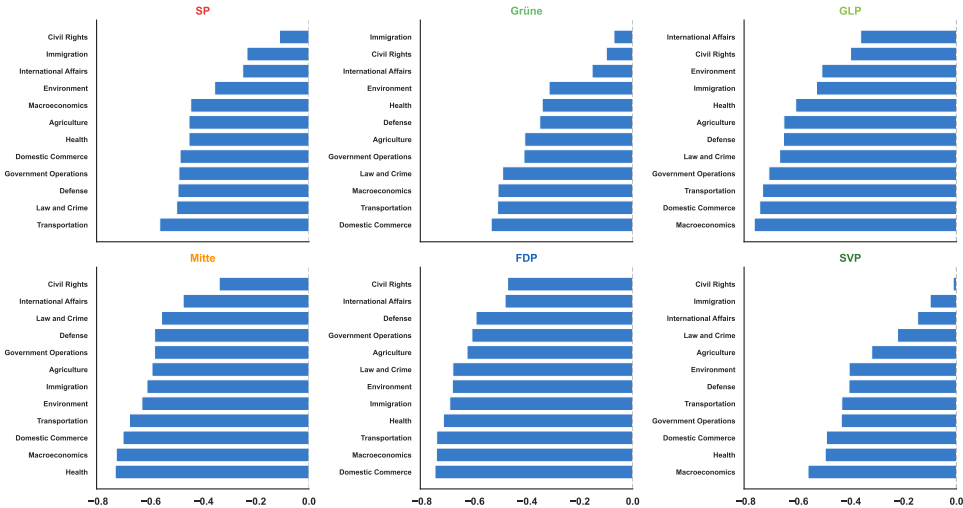


[Back to main emotion-shift driver figure.](#)

Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Topic and Party — Nationalrat



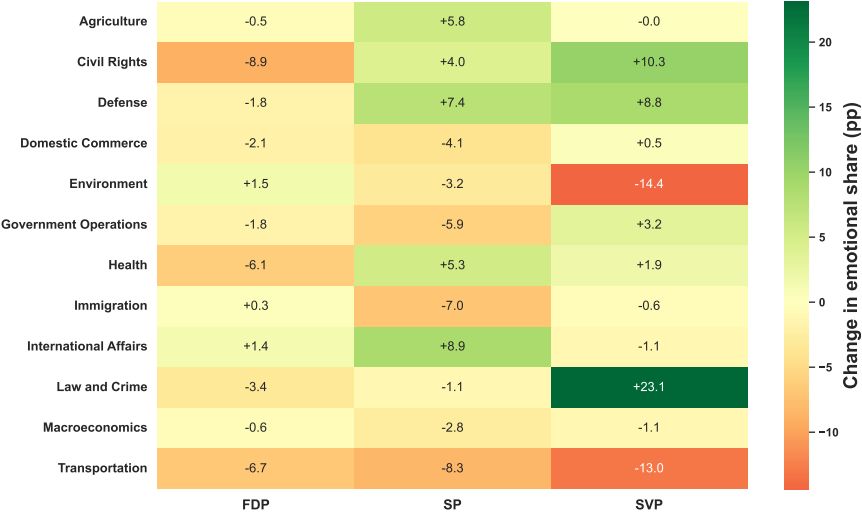
Appendix — Emotional Rhetoric by Topic, One Panel per Party — Nationalrat



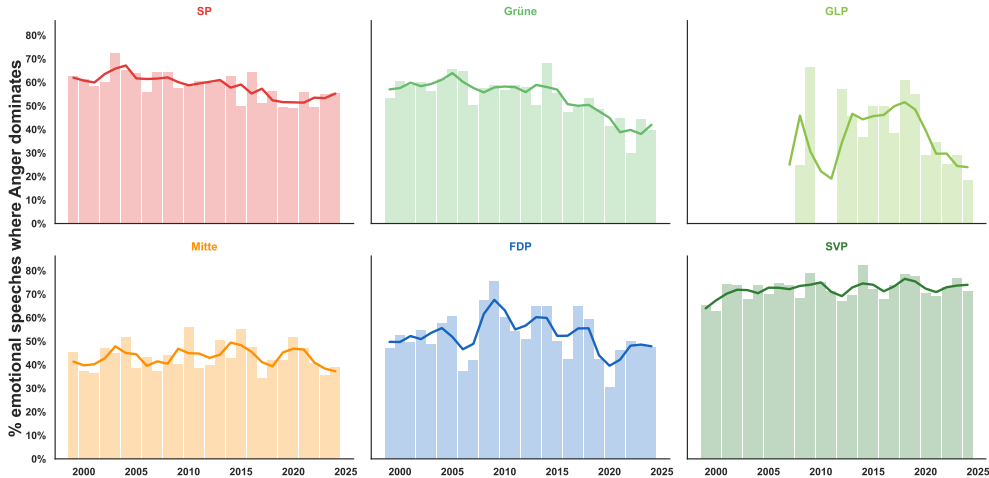
Appendix — Emotional-Rhetoric Shift by Topic and Party — Nationalrat



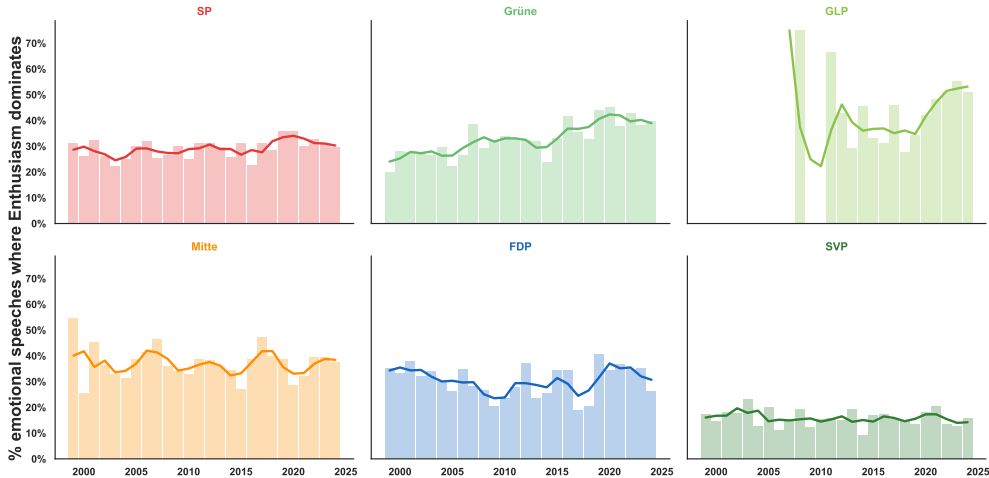
Appendix — Emotional-Rhetoric Shift by Topic and Party — Ständerat



Appendix — Anger by Party — Nationalrat



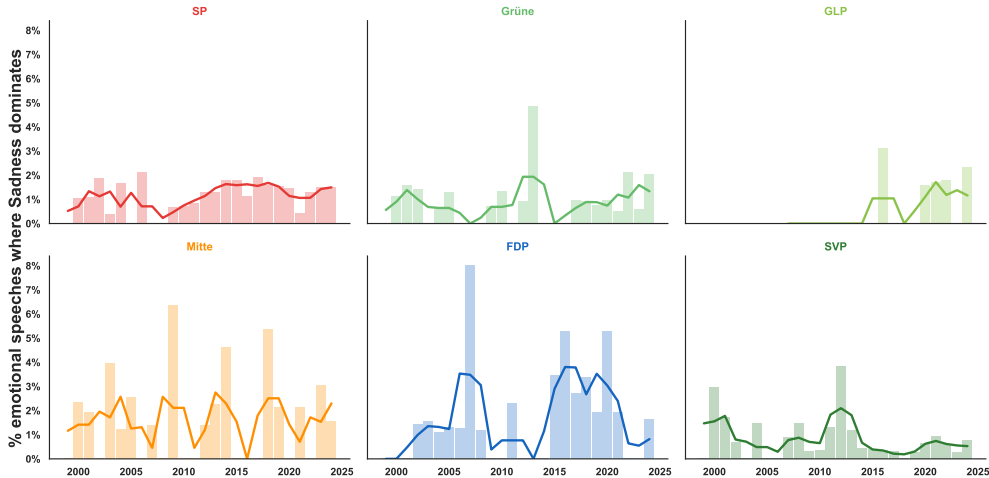
Appendix — Enthusiasm by Party — Nationalrat



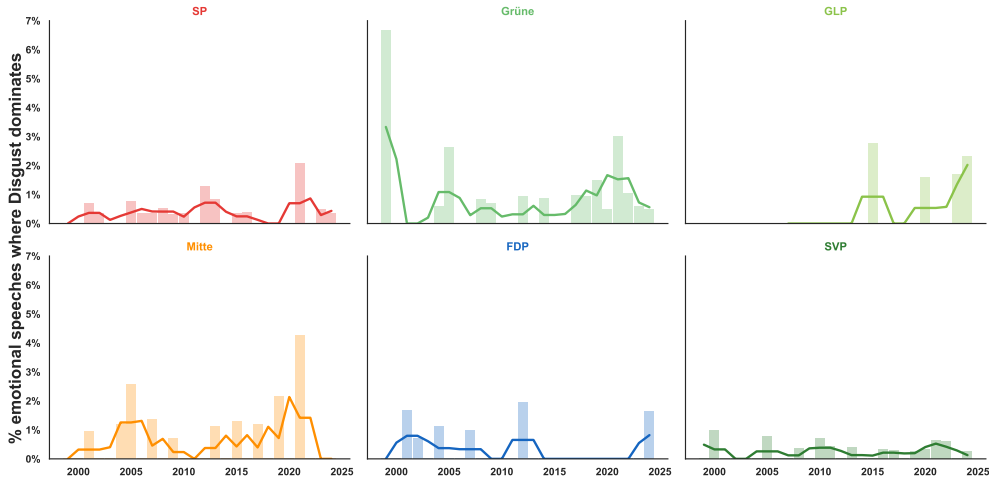
Appendix — Fear by Party — Nationalrat



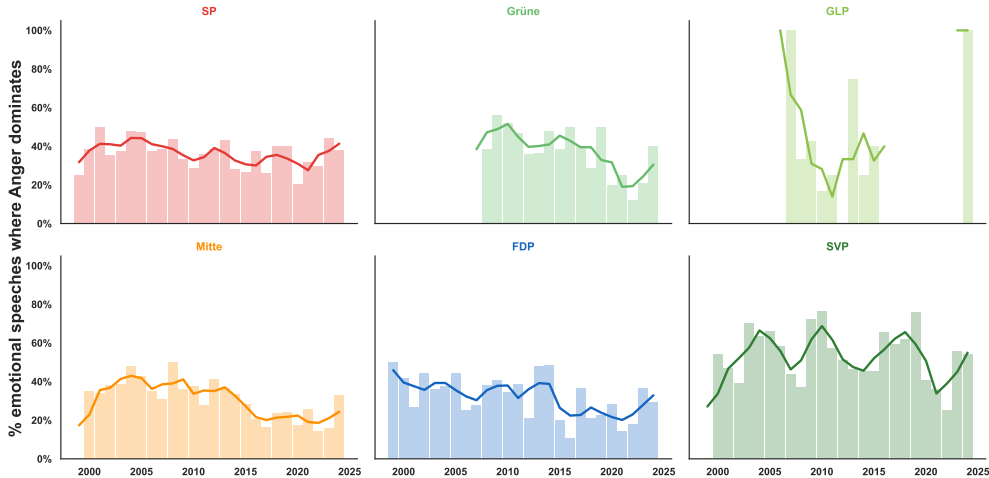
Appendix — Sadness by Party — Nationalrat



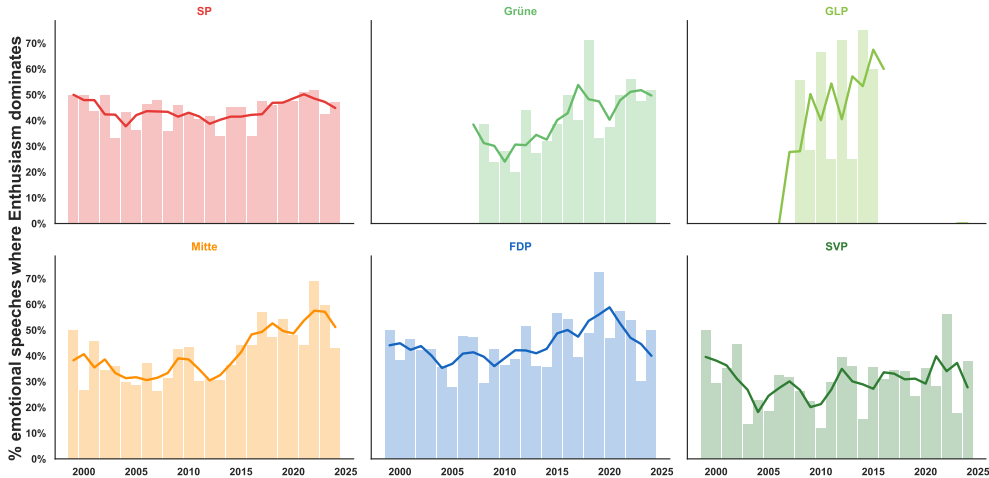
Appendix — Disgust by Party — Nationalrat



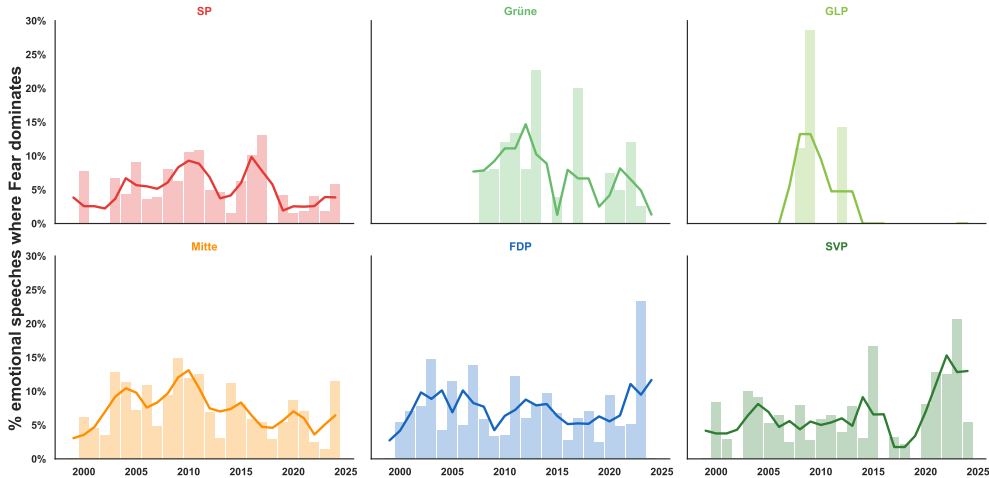
Appendix — Anger by Party — Ständerat



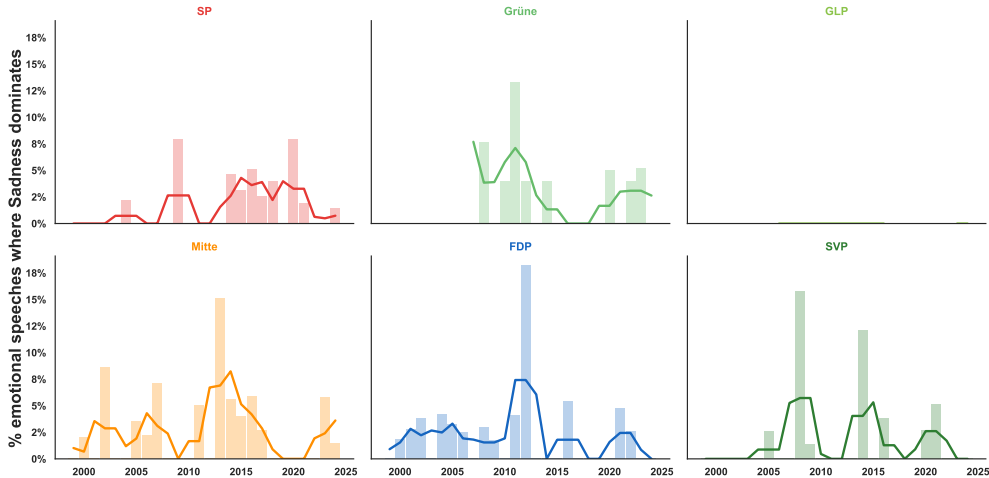
Appendix — Enthusiasm by Party — Ständerat



Appendix — Fear by Party — Ständerat



Appendix — Sadness by Party — Ständerat



Appendix — Disgust by Party — Ständerat

